



India’s policy gear has shifted: PM

‘OG’, ‘Dhurandhar’, ‘Flex’: PM Modi peppers speech with Gen Z lingo at SRCC

INDIA BACKS NEW WORLD MAP UN redraws map; America objects...

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 5

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday lashed out at critics of India's latest GDP figures, saying those responsible for pushing the country into the "Fragile Five" were now unable to accept its emergence as the world's fastest-growing major economy.

Speaking at the centenary celebrations of Shri Ram College of Commerce (SRCC) of Delhi University here, PM Modi cited India's 7.8 per cent growth in the April-June quarter as evidence of the economy's resilience amid the war in West Asia and disruptions to global trade.

"The 7.8 per cent quarterly growth has boosted the country's confidence. Those who became infa-



Prime Minister Narendra Modi interacts with children as he travels by Delhi Metro en route to SRCC for its centenary celebrations, on Saturday

mous for pushing India into the 'Fragile Five' are finding these figures difficult to digest," he said.

His remarks came amid debate over the lat-

est GDP numbers, with the Opposition questioning the figures and economists expressing differing views on the revised data and methodology under

the new GDP series.

He said the country has come a long way from policy paralysis in 2013 to policy dynamism. Modi recalled that his address

TAKEAWAYS

- » 'The 7.8 per cent quarterly growth has boosted the country's confidence. Those who became infamous for pushing India into the 'Fragile Five' are finding these figures difficult to digest'
- » He said the country has come a long way from policy paralysis in 2013 to policy dynamism
- » Modi recalled that his address in SRCC in 2013 as Gujarat chief minister had made a 'wave' and even today, its impact remains intact
- » 'In 2013, when I came to SRCC, I presented a vision. Whatever I said back then was my conviction. I have always lived by those words'

vision. Whatever I said back then was my conviction. I have always lived by those words. Dedicating my life to the nation was an emotion that took the form of words. I gave the example of a glass filled with water. Some people see the glass as half full. Some say it is half empty," PM Modi said.

"I said there are people who can see the glass as fully filled, half with water and half with air." It was a time, he said, when the country was lacking hope.

"So I said, 'I see the glass as fully filled'. At that time, development was at its lowest; inflation had hit the skies. At that time, scandals were at their peak, and the corrupt roamed fearlessly. Terrorists were unrestrained and Pakistan was out of control. **CONTINUED ON P4**

MPOST BUREAU
United Nations, September 5

The United Nations General Assembly voted Friday to adopt a new world map that aims to present the relative size of continents more accurately. The move gives Africa greater prominence while reducing the apparent size of North America and Europe, prompting opposition from the United States.

The resolution received support from 164 countries. The US voted against it, while six other states abstained, news agency AFP reported.

The map, known as the Equal Earth cartographic projection, is intended to improve "the accuracy of the cartographic representation of the world," according to the resolution.

MAPPING

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- » The resolution received support from 164 countries. The US voted against it, while six other states abstained

It calls on member states to adopt the Equal Earth map instead of the traditional Mercator projection, created by Flemish cartographer Gerardus Mercator in 1569 for maritime navigation.

The US criticised the move, arguing that the General Assembly should focus on more pressing issues. **CONTINUED ON P4**

Briefs

Nepal flood toll hits 1,344

KATHMANDU: The death toll from the devastating flash floods in Nepal surged to 1,344 on Saturday as more bodies were recovered from the affected areas, according to Nepal Police. Rescue teams continued to search for around 5,000 people, including at least 589 foreign nationals, who remain missing, while more than 13,100 people have been rescued, officials said. Among those rescued on Saturday was a 60-year-old woman who was pulled out alive from the top floor of a four-storey house, where she was trapped for 10 days, buried under mud and debris after the floods, in Bidur town in Nepal's Nuwakot district. Her family had performed symbolic last rites assuming she was dead, after they could not find her for several days following the disaster. **SEE P4**

BJP MP Dinesh Sharma is new Andaman L-G

NEW DELHI: BJP Rajya Sabha MP Dinesh Sharma was on Saturday appointed Lt Governor of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, the Rashtrapati Bhavan said. "The President of India is pleased to appoint Dr. Dinesh Sharma as Lt. Governor of Andaman and Nicobar Islands with effect from the date he assumes charge of his office," the Rashtrapati Bhavan said in a communique issued late Saturday night. Sharma, 62, earlier served as deputy chief minister of Uttar Pradesh. His Rajya Sabha term was to end on November 25. He is also the vice chairperson of the Rajya Sabha. **MPOST**

ONE-DAY POLICE CUSTODY Bhardwaj remanded; POCSO case added

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 5

Hindutva influencer Swatantra Bhardwaj was on Saturday produced before a Delhi court's judge, who remanded him to one-day police custody.

According to court sources, Bhardwaj was produced at the residence of Additional Sessions Judge Saurabh Pratap Singh Laler at around 2 pm. His legal aid counsel appeared before the judge through video-conferencing.

Bhardwaj was originally expected to be produced physically in the Patiala House courts.

On Friday, Delhi Police added provisions of the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act and criminal intimidation to the FIR against Bhardwaj for allegedly assaulting the father of a teenage activist during a BJP-led protest at Jantar Mantar in June.

KEY POINTS

- » According to court sources, Bhardwaj was produced at the residence of Additional Sessions Judge Saurabh Pratap Singh Laler at around 2 pm
- » His legal aid counsel appeared before the judge through video-conferencing
- » Bhardwaj was originally expected to be produced physically in the Patiala House courts
- » Bhardwaj was detained in Bulandshahr on Friday

He has also been booked in a POCSO case.

Bhardwaj was detained in Bulandshahr on Friday, hours after the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) staged a protest outside the Parliament Street Police Station for his arrest.

The action followed outrage over an interview in which Bhardwaj claimed he "cracked **CONTINUED ON P4**

Rain hits Delhi hard; several stretches submerged



Waterlogged road following heavy rainfall

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 5

Several parts of Delhi were waterlogged on Saturday after heavy rain, with roads submerged under knee-deep water and traffic reduced to a crawl.

Safdarjung recorded 22 mm of rainfall between 8.30 am and 11.30 am, while Palam received 25.2 mm, Lodhi Road 24.4 mm, and Ridge 6.8 mm during the period.

The downpour left

the National Highway-48 between Indira Gandhi International Airport and Dhaula Kuan inundated.

Heavy waterlogging was also reported around the Palam airport tunnel and Neem Chowk Road in Sangam Vihar. Shakarpur, Laxmi Nagar, and Mehrauli-Badarpur Road witnessed waterlogging, while several stretches in Sangam Vihar were inundated.

Mahipalpur saw particularly severe waterlogging, with vehicles struggling

to wade through water and children splashing on flooded stretches.

Heavy waterlogging was reported at Terminal 3 of the Indira Gandhi International Airport. Delhi Traffic Police on X cautioned the public about slow traffic at various locations due to waterlogging and preparations for the BRICS Summit.

A tree was reported to have fallen on Mathura Road between Apollo Hospital and Ashram Chowk. **CONTINUED ON P4**

Eight students killed in crash

Kerala: Lorry parked illegally on NH-66, say cops

MPOST BUREAU
Thrissur (Keralam), September 5

Eight engineering students from Tamil Nadu's Dindigul were killed when their car rammed into a lorry parked "illegally" on NH-66 in Thrissur district of central Keralam, police said on Saturday.

The accident occurred

around 11.40 pm on Friday at Panambikkunnu in Kaipamangalam, when the car, travelling from Guruvayur towards Kodungalur, collided with the rear of the Maharashtra-registered lorry, police said.

According to the FIR, the lorry was parked illegally on the right side of the highway near a barri-

caded stretch where traffic had been diverted as part of ongoing construction work.

Police said the car was travelling at high speed and its driver apparently failed to notice the diversion barricade before the collision.

Six students died on the spot, while two others were **CONTINUED ON P4**

'DAHI HANDI'

'Govinda Pathaks' form a human pyramid to break the 'Dahi Handi' as part of the 'Janmashtami' festival celebrations in Dadar, Mumbai, on Saturday

FROM DEC 1-JAN 4; REVISION JAN 5-9

Census 2027: 4 poll-bound states go first

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 5

Population enumeration for Census 2027 will take place in Goa, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab and parts of Uttarakhand from December 1, 2026, to January 4, 2027, the Registrar General of India said on Saturday, advancing the exercise in the states likely to go to polls early next year.

In a gazette notification, the Registrar General of India (RGI) and Census Commissioner of India Mrityunjay Kumar Narayan said the citizens in these areas can avail the option for self-enumeration from November 16 to November 30, 2026.

"The conduct of the Census of the population shall be undertaken in the States of Goa, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab and areas other

In a gazette notification, the Registrar General of India (RGI) and Census Commissioner of India Mrityunjay Kumar Narayan said the citizens in these areas can avail the option for self-enumeration from **NOVEMBER 16 TO NOVEMBER 30, 2026**

The terms of the state Assemblies of **GOA, MANIPUR, PUNJAB, UTTAR PRADESH and UTTARAKHAND** will end by May 2027, and they are likely to go to polls early next year

than snow-bound areas of the State of Uttarakhand, from 1st December, 2026 to 4th January, 2027 with a revisional round from

5th January, 2027 to 9th January, 2027," the notification said.

"For the Union territory of Ladakh and snow-bound non-syn-

chronous areas of the Union territory of Jammu and Kashmir and the snow-bound non-synchronous areas of the States of Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand, the reference date shall be 00:00 hours of the 1st day of October, 2026," it said.

According to a gazette notification issued last month, the population enumeration in Ladakh and snow-bound non-synchronous areas of Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh, and Uttarakhand would take place from September 1 to 30.

The self-enumeration window was opened for these regions from August 17 to 31.

In June last year, the government had announced the Census reference date for the country, except for Ladakh and snow-bound non-synchronous areas of the Union territory of Jammu and Kashmir and the **CONTINUED ON P4**

CBI FIR puts Subhash Chandra in spotlight

'Inflating' net worth for Rs 980-cr loans

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 5

The CBI has registered an FIR against media baron Subhash Chandra for allegedly inflating his net worth to avail loans from the Life Insurance Corporation Housing Finance Limited (LICHFL), opposing a recent NCLT repayment plan allowing creditors to recover only about Rs 6.5 crore from Chandra's personal estate against claims of roughly Rs 22,006 crore.

There was no immediate reaction from the accused named in the FIR.

The complaint concerns a Rs 500-crore facility extended to Vasant Sagar Properties Private Limited, with **CONTINUED ON P4**

and disbursal of two loans totalling Rs 980 crore.

The LICHFL was one of the lenders that had approached the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT), opposing a recent NCLT repayment plan allowing creditors to recover only about Rs 6.5 crore from Chandra's personal estate against claims of roughly Rs 22,006 crore.

There was no immediate reaction from the accused named in the FIR.

The complaint concerns a Rs 500-crore facility extended to Vasant Sagar Properties Private Limited, with **CONTINUED ON P4**

FIRST APPLICATION WINDOW REMAINS OPEN UNTIL SEPT 7

TFL, NTPC apply under ₹37,500 cr coal gasification scheme, says govt

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 5

Talcher Fertilisers Limited (TFL) and NTPC Limited have submitted applications under the Centre's Rs 37,500 crore coal and lignite gasification scheme, the Ministry of Coal said on Saturday, dismissing reports that the scheme has failed to attract applicants.

The Ministry said the first application window remains open until September 7, making it premature to assess the number of applications received.

It added that several other prospective applicants are at different stages of preparing projects and finalising their applications.

The Union Cabinet approved the Scheme for Promotion of Surface Coal/Lignite Gasification Projects on May 13, 2026, with a total financial outlay of Rs 37,500 crore.

The scheme seeks to promote the conversion of domestic coal and lignite into higher-value products, including syngas, methanol, ammonia and urea.



THE UNION CABINET APPROVED THE SCHEME FOR PROMOTION OF SURFACE COAL/LIGNITE GASIFICATION PROJECTS ON MAY 13, 2026, WITH A TOTAL FINANCIAL OUTLAY OF RS 37,500 CRORE

The ministry said the scheme is expected to catalyse investments of around Rs 2.5 lakh crore to Rs 3 lakh crore across nearly 25 projects and generate about 50,000 direct and indirect employment opportunities.

It is also expected to contribute to the government's broader objective of achieving 100 million tonnes of coal gasification capacity by 2030, the ministry said.

"The assertion that the Scheme has received 'no takers' is factually incorrect," the ministry said, pointing to the applications submitted by TFL and NTPC.

KEY POINTS

- » The scheme seeks to promote the conversion of domestic coal and lignite into higher-value products, including syngas, methanol, ammonia and urea
- » The ministry said the scheme is expected to catalyse investments of around Rs 2.5 lakh cr to Rs 3 lakh cr across nearly 25 projects and generate about 50,000 direct and indirect employment opportunities
- » It is also expected to contribute to the government's broader objective of achieving 100 million tonnes of coal gasification capacity by 2030

The ministry said it had undertaken stakeholder outreach after the scheme's approval, including roadshows in New Delhi, Hyderabad and Mumbai, followed by the issuance of the Request for Proposal on July 7 and the launch of an online application portal.

A pre-application conference was held on July

20 to address queries on eligibility, scheme provisions and the application process, it said.

The ministry noted that large-scale coal and lignite gasification projects require substantial preparation, including technology assessment, feedstock arrangements, project economics and preparation of detailed proposals. It therefore expects additional applicants to submit proposals as the deadline approaches.

The scheme will also allow companies multiple opportunities to participate through rolling application rounds.

After one round closes, the next round will open from the following day and remain open for two months, allowing prospective applicants additional time to complete project preparation. The ministry said participation should be assessed after completion of the prescribed application process and subsequent rounds rather than at the current interim stage.

Adani Defence inks five-year pact to supply ammunition for AK-203 rifles

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 5

Adani Defence & Aerospace has signed a five-year agreement with Indo-Russian Rifles Pvt Ltd (IRRPL) to supply indigenously produced 7.62x39 mm ammunition for AK-203 assault rifles being manufactured in India, creating an integrated domestic supply chain for the India-Russia rifle programme.

Under the agreement, Adani Defence will supply the small-calibre ammunition required for the AK-203 programme for five years, providing an Indian source of supply and supporting continuity of ammunition availability over the contract period, according to the company.

The pact brings together rifle production by Indo-Russian Rifles, or IRRPL, and ammunition manufacturing by Adani Defence, linking two parts of the AK-203 programme within India's defence manufacturing ecosystem.

IRRPL was established in 2019 under an India-Russia intergovernmental agreement to manufacture AK-203 rifles for the Indian Armed Forces. Its manufacturing facility is located



at Korwa in Uttar Pradesh's Amethi district.

The joint venture has Indian shareholders Advanced Weapons and Equipment India Ltd and Munitions India Ltd, along with Russian shareholders Concern Kalashnikov and Rosoboronexport.

The Ministry of Defence has identified IRRPL as the joint venture responsible for indigenous production of the AK-203.

The government signed a contract with the company in December 2021 for 6,01,427 AK-203 rifles, which are to be manufactured at the Korwa facility.

The latest agreement expands the domestic manufacturing footprint around the programme by pairing locally produced rifles with locally manufac-

tured ammunition, according to the firm.

Adani Defence has established small-calibre ammunition manufacturing capabilities in India, including a production facility in Kanpur.

The agreement would further strengthen domestic capabilities across the small-arms supply chain and support the government's Aatmanirbhar Bharat push for greater self-reliance in defence manufacturing.

The agreement also deepens the localisation of an India-Russia defence programme that was originally established to manufacture AK-203 rifles domestically, reducing reliance on external sources for a key consumable required for the weapon system.

Former Tata Tech CEO McGoldrick sells shares worth ₹165 crore

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 5

Patrick Raymon McGoldrick, former CEO and Managing Director of Tata Technologies, has sold 21 lakh shares worth nearly Rs 165 crore through block deals on the BSE.

McGoldrick sold the shares in four tranches on Friday at an average price of Rs 785 apiece, representing a 0.51 per cent stake. His holding in the Pune-based engineering services company declined to 0.62 per cent from 1.13 per cent.

ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund, Kotak Mahindra MF, 360 One Asset Management, and Carnelian Asset Management & Advisors acquired an equal number of shares at the same price.

McGoldrick retired as CEO and MD in September 2014 after 20 years with Tata Technologies. He is currently an Executive Director at RNT Associates International Pte Ltd. The company reported an 8 per cent rise in consolidated net profit to Rs 204.17 crore in the March quarter, while revenue rose to Rs 1,572.22 crore. For FY26, net profit stood at Rs 546.59 crore and revenue at Rs 5,505.57 crore.

LIC receives RBI's nod to acquire up to 9.99% stake in ICICI Bank

ANI NEWS
New Delhi, September 5

Public sector insurer Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) has received approval from the RBI to acquire an aggregate holding of up to 9.99 per cent of the paid-up share capital or voting rights in private lender ICICI Bank, according to a regulatory filing.

As per the exchange filing, ICICI Bank received the RBI's approval letter dated September 4, 2026, at 9:09 pm the same day. The approval allows LIC



to acquire the stake within one year from the date of the RBI's letter, after which it will lapse.

Also, the acquisition will be subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements.

"The approval is subject to certain conditions including compliance with

the relevant statutory and regulatory provisions," the filing read.

"On September 4, 2026 at 9:09 p.m., ICICI Bank Limited (the Bank) has received a copy of RBI letter dated the same day addressed to LIC (the applicant) that it has accorded its approval to the applicant to acquire 'aggregate holding' of up to 9.99 per cent of the paid-up share capital or voting rights in the Bank within one year from the date of RBI approval letter, failing which RBI approval shall stand cancelled."

After 10 years of India feat, Reliance Jio sets sights on global market, says Akash Ambani

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 5

Digital services major Jio is setting its sights on global markets with made-in-India technology spanning connectivity, digital products, enterprise solutions and artificial intelligence, Jio Platforms Managing Director and Reliance Jio Chairman Akash Ambani said on Saturday.

In a letter to employees marking Jio's 10 years, Ambani said the company has built the foundation of

Digital India at an unprecedented scale, accelerated the country's transition to 5G and connected homes and businesses.

"Jio today is much more than a telecom company," Ambani said, adding that the company is building original technology in India and aims to take these technologies global, strengthening the country's position as a creator of technology for the world.

Jio began commercial mobile services on September 5, 2016, through Reliance Jio Infocomm, making voice calls free for the first time in the country.

Its network trials began with employees on December 28, 2015, and were later extended to friends and employees of Reliance Industries.

Services remained free for all subscribers for six months after the commercial launch.

Jio crossed 50 million subscribers in 83 days and 100 million in less than six months.

Following a restructur-

ing, Reliance Jio became a subsidiary of Jio Platforms, incorporated in November 2019.

The company had 533.3 million customers as of June 30, 2026, and now ranks among the world's largest data operators, carrying over 23 exabytes of traffic every month.

Jio has added nearly 500 million net subscribers over the decade, more than the top three US telecom operators combined and over 1.3 times the nearest Indian competitor.

rupted that trade by adding substantially more shares to the market than some traders had anticipated. The increased supply, together with positions built by hedge funds ahead of the rebalance, contributed to the slump in Adani Energy shares, the steepest in about seven months. About \$569 million of the stock changed hands.

A representative for GQG Partners declined to comment, while a spokesperson for the Adani Group didn't respond to an email seeking comment. An exchange filing Thursday showed GQG Partners held a 3.46% stake in Adani Energy as of Aug. 31, down from 5.1% in June 2023. The fund said its holding disclosed in June 2023 had undergone "multiple acquisition and sale transactions" over the period.

FICCI CASCADE launches All India Creator Awards 2026

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 5

FICCI CASCADE has launched the "All India Creator Awards 2026", a first-of-its-kind national initiative encouraging creators to use original storytelling and filmmaking to raise awareness about the impact of smuggling and counterfeiting.

The initiative is part of MASCRAGE 2026 - Movement Against Smuggled and Counterfeit Trade, scheduled for September

17-18, 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi.

Creators can submit original vertical films of 60-90 seconds in Hindi, English, Hinglish or any regional language, with a maximum of two entries based on different themes.

The six themes are The Future We Risk; Job Losses Behind Illicit Trade; Building Viksit Bharat; Every Choice Counts; The Hidden Cost of Illicit Trade; and Building Awareness, Combating Illicit Trade.

Entries will be judged

on a 100-point framework covering Impact & Clarity of Message (20), Storytelling & Craft (25), Factual Accuracy (20), Originality (10) and Organic Engagement (25).

First, second and third-prize winners will receive creator kits worth approximately Rs 1.2 lakh, Rs 80,000 and Rs 50,000, respectively. Ten selected reels will also feature on FICCI CASCADE's official channels.

The submission deadline is September 9, 2026.

Tata Sons successor race narrows to Narendran, Agrawal & NSE's Ashish Chauhan

Tata Sons board & the trusts that control the holding company are likely to play key role in choosing next chairman

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 5

Tata Sons, the holding company of the \$275-billion-plus Tata conglomerate, has narrowed its search for a successor to Chairman N Chandrasekaran to three prominent corporate leaders - Tata Steel CEO and MD T V Narendran, Tata Sons Executive Director and Group CFO Saurabh Agrawal, and NSE MD and CEO Ashish Chauhan, people familiar with the matter said.

While Narendran has

emerged as the frontrunner among internal candidates, Agrawal is also in the reckoning with his investment-banking and capital-allocation experience, while Chauhan, a veteran of India's capital markets and one of the founding executives of the National Stock Exchange, could turn out to be the dark horse, the people said.

The selection process is still underway, and no final decision has been taken.

The Tata Sons board and the trusts that control the holding company

are expected to play a key role in choosing the next chairman.

Sources said Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata has flagged the shortlisted candidates to top government leaders and a decision is likely once the names are thoroughly debated.

Tata Trusts and Tata Sons did not immediately respond to emailed requests for comment.

Chandrasekaran, who took over as Tata Sons chairman in 2017 and is currently serving his second five-year term,

CLOSER LOOK

- » Narendran brings Tata pedigree and is considered the natural internal contender for the top job, but his career has been almost entirely within Tata Steel
- » Chauhan, on the other hand, brings a markedly different profile. The NSE chief has deep experience in technology, capital markets, financial services and institution building

announced last month that he would not seek reappointment when his tenure ends on February 20, 2027.

While a formal process to find his successor has been set in motion,

no shortlist has been officially confirmed. Other names that have surfaced include Noel Tata himself, who could serve as interim chairman if the committee cannot conclude the process in time; Tata Sons'

Group Chief Digital Officer Aarthi Subramanian; Tata Motors CEO Shailesh Chandra; and Tata Power CEO Praveer Sinha.

According to people familiar with the discussions, Chauhan could be the surprise choice.

Narendran brings Tata pedigree and is considered the natural internal contender for the top job, but his career has been almost entirely within Tata Steel, and he has relatively less experience at the holding-company level and in capital allocation.

Chauhan, on the other hand, brings a markedly different profile.

The NSE chief has deep experience in technology, capital markets, financial services and institution building.

He was among the executives who helped establish the NSE in the 1990s and later served as MD and CEO of the Bombay Stock Exchange before returning to NSE as its chief in 2022.

An IIT Bombay graduate with a postgraduate management degree from IIM Calcutta, Chau-

han has also worked at Reliance Industries and IDBI Bank.

He is presently steering a Rs 30,000-crore IPO of NSE - the largest in Indian history so far that will value the stock exchange at about Rs 5 lakh crore and place it among the 10 most valuable Indian companies by market capitalisation.

His candidature could offer the Tata Group an external-looking choice without bringing in a completely unknown face, people familiar with his profile said.

CM REKHA SAYS EDUCATION REFORMS UNDERWAY
Teachers take centre stage
Govt honours 118 teachers, principals on Teachers' Day

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 5

The Delhi government on Saturday felicitated 118 teachers and principals with state awards on Teachers' Day, with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta saying the government is working to improve education by addressing gaps in school infrastructure as well as curriculum.

Addressing the Shikshak Mahakumbh - State Teachers Awards 2026 at Thyagaraj Stadium, Gupta said the government aims to take education to "great heights" and make significant progress, but the process had to begin by addressing basic facilities in schools.

"We want to take education to great heights and make a lot of progress, but the previous governments did not do anything in 12 years. So, after coming to power, we have had to start working from a very low level," she said.

Gupta said the government was working on repairing toilets, ensuring water facilities, maintenance, whitewashing and other repair works in schools.

"Many schools had very poor toilet facilities. Once, I went for an inspection to a very good and reputed school, which the previous government used to boast about. When I saw it, there was no gate in the toilet. How would our girl students have been using it?"



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta felicitates during the 'Teachers' Maha Kumbh - State Teachers Award 2026', on Saturday

CLOSER LOOK

- » We want to take education to great heights and make a lot of progress, but the previous governments did not do anything in 12 years. So, after coming to power, we have had to start working from a very low level: CM Rekha Gupta
- » Gupta said the government was working on repairing toilets, ensuring water facilities, maintenance, whitewashing and other repair works in schools
- » She said the Delhi government was committed to ensuring quality education for every child and had allocated Rs 19,148 crore for education in the 2026-27 financial year

she said. Apart from infrastructure, the government is also working on courses and curriculum, Gupta said, adding that the Education Department and Education

Minister Ashish Sood were continuously working on these issues and progress was being made.

The chief minister said teachers were the strong

foundation of society and did not merely impart textbook knowledge, but also instilled values, skills, confidence, a sense of duty and the right direction in students.

She said the Delhi government was committed to ensuring quality education for every child and had allocated Rs 19,148 crore for education in the 2026-27 financial year.

Gupta said 170 modern language labs were being established in schools to strengthen students' language and communication skills. Of these, 70 would be in CM Shri Schools and 100 in other government schools.

MCD schools get a new game plan

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 5

On Teachers' Day, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) announced a set of education and sports initiatives aimed at reshaping its municipal school system, combining upgraded infrastructure with parental participation and structured grassroots sports.

At a teacher felicitation ceremony at the Kedarnath Sahni Auditorium in the Civic Centre on Saturday, Union Minister of State and Delhi BJP president Harsh Malhotra and Mayor Pravesh Wahi felicitated 87 educators, including four principals and 83 teachers.

24 schools as benchmarks

The centrepiece of the announcements was the proposed 24 NigamShri Schools of Excellence, with two schools to be identified



in each of MCD's 12 zones. The selected schools will retain the existing MCD curriculum while focusing on foundational literacy and numeracy, activity-based learning and improved infrastructure. Each school will mentor three to five neighbouring municipal schools, creating a network for sharing academic resources and practices. The schools are also expected to have smart-enabled classrooms, libraries, sports facilities and accessibility features

for children with special needs. Teachers and principals will receive continuous professional development.

Bringing parents into learning

The MCD also launched Pratibhagita, an initiative focused on strengthening school-home partnerships. In collaboration with non-profit organisation Rocket Learning, parents of pre-primary children will receive play-based learning activities and audio-visual guidance for use at

home. For primary-school parents, the programme will provide information on students, school activities and MCD initiatives through technology-enabled communication.

Sport as a talent pipeline

The MCD Mini League will introduce structured football and cricket competitions for Under-9 and Under-11 students. The programme will use digital registration, match analytics and fitness assessments to identify and track young talent. More than 1,400 MCD students are expected to compete alongside over 4,500 children from Delhi-NCR sports academies. The initiatives mark an attempt to move municipal education beyond classroom infrastructure towards a broader ecosystem involving teachers, parents, sports and community participation.

NDMC Suvidha Camp receives 56 grievances

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 5

The New Delhi Municipal Council's (NDMC) monthly Suvidha Camp received 56 public grievances on Saturday, with over 100 officials from 30 departments attending to residents and service users. Held at the NDCC Convention Centre on Jai Singh Road, the camp served as a single-window platform for citizens to register complaints, seek information and interact directly with officials regarding civic services. Most of the grievances were related to the Personnel, Civil Engineering, Horticulture, Public Health, Enforcement, Commercial, Tax and Estate departments, according to the civic body. Officials said the complaints were taken up by the concerned departments for necessary action.

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 5

In a room filled with colours, brushes and canvases, age appears to lose its meaning. At the 'The First Show' art exhibition, organised by DKG India, children as young as five and adults over 85 come together, united by a common language art.

The exhibition, inaugurated on September 3 at The Stainless Gallery in New Friends Colony, showcases more than 140 vibrant and thematic artworks created by 70 students of artist and organiser Dipak Kumar Ghosh. The opening ceremony began with a 'Light A Lamp' ritual, with Ghosh lighting the first lamp, followed by his students.

For Ghosh, however, the exhibition is about more than displaying artwork.



His initiative, centred on "Building a Creative Community Through Art", seeks to identify latent talent while creating a space where people across generations can learn and grow together.

His philosophy of "Bridging the Age" is reflected in the diversity of his students. Young children work alongside elderly participants, allowing generations to exchange experiences and perspectives. While older participants share their life experiences, younger students develop a greater

sense of empathy and care towards them. Art, Ghosh believes, can also provide an emotional outlet. Students experiencing stress and self-doubt are encouraged to work freely, helping them regain confidence and a sense of self-worth.

The exhibition will remain open to visitors until September 6, from 11 a.m. to 7 p.m. A live workshop, 'Play With Colors Without A Brush', has been conducted on September 5 as part of Teachers' Day celebrations, with more than 50 students participating.

NDMC honours 13 teachers

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 5

The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on Saturday honoured 13 teachers with the "NDMC Teachers' Award 2026" for their contribution to improving the quality of education and the overall development of students.

The awards were presented by NDMC Chairperson Manoj Kumar Dwivedi at a Teachers' Day ceremony held at Navyug School in Sarojini Nagar. The awardees included eight teachers from Atal Adarsh Vidyalayas and five from Navyug Schools.

The recipients were recognised for their dedication, professional commitment, innovative approaches and efforts towards academic and holistic development of students. Each teacher was presented a citation, shield, shawl and a cash prize of Rs 15,000.

Addressing the gathering, Dwivedi said teachers had a role that extended beyond classroom instruction and academic performance. "Education is not only confined to marks, examinations or medals," he said, emphasising the importance of values, empathy, discipline, social skills and a responsible approach towards life.

He urged teachers to make continuous learning part of their routine and suggested that they record at least one new learning every day for a year.

DIRECTS SWIFT DRAINAGE AMID HEAVY RAIN
CM inspects waterlogged areas

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 5

As heavy rains hit the city, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta conducted a surprise inspection of waterlogged areas near Sadbhavna Park in East Delhi on Saturday.

During the inspection, she assessed areas prone to waterlogging, reviewed the cleanliness of major roads, and received updates on the water drainage system and the challenges posed by the ongoing rains.

"She directed officials to immediately deploy pumps and other necessary resources in waterlogged areas and ensure swift clearance of accumulated water," the Chief Minister's Office said in a statement.

Gupta also instructed officials to strengthen the drainage system further during the monsoon season and ensure that no area experiences waterlog-



ging, the statement added.

The chief minister emphasised that all concerned departments must work with complete preparedness, promptness and coordination to ensure that Delhi residents do not face inconvenience due to rainfall.

The inspection comes a day after several parts of the city were waterlogged,

particularly areas around Indira Gandhi International Airport.

In light of the upcoming international BRICS summit next week on September 12 and 13, senior officials from the Delhi government also inspected the route from Bharat Mandapam to IGI Airport to identify any potential issues.

Narela shooting: No arrest yet

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 5

More than 48 hours after a 42-year-old man was shot dead in broad daylight near a gym in Narela and fifteen empty cartridges were recovered from the spot, the two unidentified assailants are still at large, officials said.

Police said Pramod Kumar, a resident of Nahri village, was allegedly shot multiple times by two men near a gym close to Delhi Hospital in Bakner around

6:50 am on September 3.

Police recovered fifteen empty cartridges from the spot, indicating the intensity of the attack.

Officials said four teams comprising personnel from the local police and Special Staff have been deployed to work on the case.

Following the incident, Kumar's family members and residents blocked the road and demanded the immediate arrest of those responsible.

Police officials reached the spot and assured the

protesters that teams had been formed to trace the accused.

Investigators are examining CCTV footage from the area and gathering local intelligence to establish the identity and movements of the shooters.

Police said an FIR has been registered at Narela police station under Sections 103(I), 109(I), 351(2) and 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and relevant provisions of the Arms Act against unidentified persons.

DELHI POLICE
SHANTI SEWA NYAYA

GST FRAUD?

THINK TWICE

GST fraud is not just a financial irregularity it's a PUNISHABLE OFFENCE

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False bills, real trouble.
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Wrong claims, wrong impact.
- Fictitious firms**
Fake businesses, real damage.
- Tax evasion**
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FOR IMMEDIATE POLICE HELP CALL 112 TO SHARE INFORMATION CALL 14547

13-year-old girl dies by suicide after being scolded for returning home late in Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 5

A 13-year-old girl allegedly died by suicide at her residence in Delhi's Shahdara after she was scolded by family members for returning home late, police said on Saturday.

The girl was found unconscious on the floor of her home in Krishna Nagar after her sister noticed her hanging and brought her down, police said.

Police received a PCR call regarding the incident and reached the spot. The girl was rushed to Dr Hedgewar Hospital, where doctors declared her dead, they said.

During preliminary inquiry, police learnt that the girl had returned home late and was scolded by her family members. Later, her sister found her hanging and raised an alarm, following which she was brought down and taken to the hospital. Speaking to reporters, a neighbour said that he works with the deceased's sister.

"While at work, her sister called her around 9.30 pm. Despite calling multiple times, she didn't pick up and hence she rushed home," he said.

"She knocked multiple times but then we broke the door. Her sister found her hanging by a rope. She only cut the rope and got her body down," he added.

CM CONDUCTS AERIAL SURVEY

Bihar reeling under flood as over 16 lakh across 11 districts affected

MPOST BUREAU

Patna, September 5

Bihar was reeling under floods on Saturday when over 16 lakh people across 11 districts were affected by the calamity, while a large part of the state capital was inundated by swollen rivers. Rising water levels of the Ganga and its tributary Punpun inundated several areas in rural Patna, causing disruption in rail and road traffic while low-lying areas of the city were submerged.

Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary flew to Bhagalpur and reviewed rescue and relief operations in the district where the situation remains grim a week after an embankment was breached following a steep rise in water levels.

Choudhary shared on his X handle snapshots of his tour during which he conducted an aerial survey of Bhagalpur and its Naugachia subdivision, and an on-site inspection of the damaged Koji Koraiya bandh. "Protection from floods and safety of the common public is our top priority. Instructions were issued to officials to continually monitor embankments, keep special watch on vulnerable areas and ensure promptness in relief and rescue work," Choudhary said in the post. The disaster management department stated that 2.32 lakh people were hit by floods in Patna, one of the worst-affected districts. Local MP



An area inundated by floodwaters following the rise of Ganga River, in Patna, on Saturday

CLOSER LOOK

- » Heavy rains have been battering the city for the past few days, causing heavy water-logging in areas far away from the river bed as well
- » Streets leading to the Patna airport saw long queues of vehicles moving through knee-deep water. Due to the rise in water levels of several rivers, around 16.85 lakh people in 300 gram panchayats across 61 blocks in 11 districts

ter management department stated that 2.32 lakh people were hit by floods in Patna, one of the worst-affected districts. Local MP

Ravi Shankar Prasad toured the rural areas which have been ravaged by the waters of the Ganga and Punpun. The East Central Railway

came out with a list of trains that have been cancelled or diverted because of "high water level at Bridge number 21" that connects Punpun and Parsa Bazar stations. In Athmalgola block, NH-31 was left inundated, bringing vehicular traffic to a grinding halt. On his X handle, Prasad wrote that he "met villagers and listened to their problems" besides giving "instructions to officials that there should be no laxity in relief and rescue operations and adequate supply of food,

medicines and other essential items be ensured". The water resources department warned that the level of the Ganga rose by 10 cm since the previous day to cross the "highest flood level (HFL)" at two places, including Gandhi Ghat, which is adjacent to the National Institute of Technology and a stone's throw from Patna University. Heavy rains have been battering the city for the past few days, causing heavy water-logging in areas far away from the river bed as well.

From page 1

India's policy...

"Today, those spreading terrorism are trounced. If Pakistan indulges in any nefarious act, the Indian army enters their home and strikes; the back of Naxalism has been broken... from policy paralysis to policy dynamism, India has come a long way.

Modi said there were some who questioned his optimism and raised doubts about initiatives like 'Make in India'.

Lauding SRCC for shaping generations, PM referred to college alumni as "OG", striking a chord with Gen Z. PM Modi addressed students in a language familiar to the younger generation having a Gen Z-style way of describing its alumni at the celebration.

Addressing the young audience, Modi switched to language that students would instantly recognise, using terms such as "OG" and "flex" while talking about the college and its alumni.

"If I say it in Gen Z language, they are OG," Modi said, referring to SRCC's former students and their achievements across different fields.

He then added his own line: "Dhurandhar na ho, lekin dhoom toh machayi hai." (They may not be the most formidable, but they have certainly made their mark.)

"When a human being lives for 100 years, they are considered a person of deep knowledge and great experience. When an institution completes 100 years, it becomes an ocean of achievements. SRCC has shaped generations and connected them to a brighter future," he said.

"In its 100-year journey, Shri Ram College of Commerce has shaped generations, connecting them to a bright future. Those who came, they studied; those who left, they left sculpted. SRCC alumni have been very special. In your language, they are OGs," he said. The prime minister also released a commemorative Rs 100 coin to mark the centenary celebration.

Modi's visit to the SRCC comes amid the BJP's ongoing outreach to the young generation.

At a separate function while interacting with the national award-winning teachers, Modi asked the teachers to preserve childhood and nurture children's natural curiosity.

He said teachers should share creative approaches to make classroom learning more engaging. The prime minister emphasised that teachers need to look beyond the academic performance of children and be attentive to their behaviour and everyday

lives. He said teachers have an increasingly important role to play in the lives of children now that there are fewer joint family set-ups.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

UN redraws...

US representative Yaryna Ferencevych said such initiatives are "the reason this institution is losing its credibility."

India voted in favour of the resolution aimed at correcting the world map to promote a "more accurate representation" of continental landmasses.

The resolution was sponsored by Togo, receiving 164 votes in favour, with abstentions from Estonia, Georgia, Lithuania, Moldova, Serbia and Ukraine, and a lone vote against from the United States.

The resolution noted that the Mercator projection, designed in the 16th century for navigational purposes, remains widely used in educational, media, digital and official materials, despite the considerable distortion of landmasses to the North and South, far from the equator.

The resolution also noted with "concern" that "this distortion contributes to minimising the perceived sizes of Africa, Latin America and South Asia, and perpetuating an unbalanced view of the world."

In an explanation of the vote in the General Assembly, First Secretary at the Permanent Mission of India to the UN, Raghuo Puri, said India "welcomes" the intention behind the resolution to promote more accurate and representative cartographic practices.

"We believe that maps play an important role in how societies understand geography and the relative scale of the world around us," he said.

However, India clarified its understanding of the scope of this resolution, saying, "We believe that the resolution should be understood as supporting the broader use and consideration of Equal Area map projections, and not as endorsing the Equal Earth projection or any other specific map projection."

Equal Area projections are particularly relevant because they preserve the relative sizes or areas of continental and territorial landmasses, Puri said.

"This can help address distortions in perceived landmass size that arise from projections designed primarily to preserve other geographic characteristics such as shape, direction, or distance. At the same time,

different projections serve different cartographic purposes. No single projection is necessarily appropriate for every application.

He said India's position is limited to the principle of encouraging Equal Area approaches where the objective is to preserve the relative sizes of continental landmasses.

The resolution affirmed that cartographic distortions of continental sizes inherited from history have cognitive, educational, cultural, geopolitical and socioeconomic impacts and constitute historical biases, the correction of which will promote recognition, justice and development, particularly about the African continent.

The resolution declares that the Equal Earth cartographic projection offers a more accurate representation of the sizes of continental landmasses.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Rain hits...

The stretch from Rotary Chowk to DJB Chowk and the route towards Omaxe via Radha Swami Satsang Bhavan and DJB Chowk, Road Number 210 from Rotary Chowk to DJB Chowk, DJB Red Light-Omaxe Road, Omaxe Road in Dwarka covering Sectors 1, 7, 8, 9, 10 and 20, and the NH-8 underpass were waterlogged.

Among other stations, Aya Nagar recorded 13.4 mm of rain, Pusa 13.5 mm, Mayur Vihar 7 mm, Jafarpur 2.5 mm, Chhatarpur 22 mm, Janakpuri 8.5 mm, Naraina 20.5 mm, Jharoda Kalan 4.5 mm and Pritampura 2.2 mm between 8.30 am and 11.30 am.

The city remained under orange and red alerts for a major part of the morning and early afternoon.

The India Meteorological Department issued a general orange alert for the rest of the day, forecasting thunderstorms accompanied by lightning and light to moderate rainfall, with moderate to heavy rainfall expected at many places from the afternoon through the evening.

Thunderstorms accompanied by lightning and light to moderate rainfall are also expected during the night, the IMD said.

Eight students...

declared dead on arrival at a nearby hospital, police said.

The deceased were students of an engineering college in Dindigul and were travelling towards Kodungallur along NH-66.

Police said five of the deceased—Surya, Yuvasanjith, Joshua, Murali and Jeeva—were from Dindigul,

while Santhosh and Prasanna were from Madurai and Vishva was from Salem. The students were pulled out of the mangled car during a rescue operation involving residents, fire and rescue personnel and police.

Their bodies were taken to the mortuary at Thrissur Medical College, police said.

Kaipamangalam police have registered a case against the lorry driver under Section 105 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita for culpable homicide. The driver went into hiding soon after the accident, police said.

Police contacted the families of the deceased using student identity cards recovered from the victims. Some of the families were unaware that their children had travelled to Keralam, police said.

Relatives told police that Santhosh had recently purchased a car and that the group had planned a trip to Kochi. As the registration of the car had not been completed, they hired a rented vehicle for the trip, they said.

Postmortem examinations were conducted at Thrissur Medical College, where relatives arrived to receive the bodies.

Hospital authorities arranged ambulances to transport the bodies to their respective native places.

Thrissur Rural District Police Chief Mohammad Nadeemuddin said a preliminary investigation indicated that the accident occurred due to the lorry driver's fault.

"It is definitely a mistake on the part of the lorry driver. An FIR has already been registered. Additionally, regarding the highway authorities and the contractor, we will inspect that as part of the investigation and take strict action," he told reporters.

Bhardwaj...

the skull" of the minor activist's father, Sanjay, on June 23 during the CJP protest and escaped arrest because of his political connections.

"I cracked the skull... Do you know which section this crime attracts? Section 307. He needed 60 stitches," he said on a video podcast.

Delhi Police earlier said Sanjay's injuries were simple in nature and were caused by a steel bracelet.

Facing backlash, Bhardwaj later claimed in a podcast that he acted in self-defence.

On Friday, police registered a fresh FIR under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act against him on a complaint by the minor activist, alleging

online threats and harassment.

The police also reportedly invoked BNS sections 351(3), 78 (stalking) and 79 (insulting the modesty of a woman), besides Section 67 of the Information Technology Act.

The minor, who describes herself as an atheist and a humanitarian, alleged that she was threatened with rape, subjected to verbal abuse and morphed images after speaking out against the assault on her father and filing a police complaint.

Azad Samaj Party (Kanshi Ram) chief and Nagina MP Chandrashekar Azad also met police officers at the Parliament Street Police Station and sought action against Bhardwaj.

The delegation also demanded the addition of attempt-to-murder, criminal intimidation and SC/ST Act provisions to the case and a separate FIR over alleged rape threats and online abuse targeting the girl.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Census 2027...

snow-bound non-synchronous areas of the states of Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand, to be 00.00 hours of March 1, 2027.

The population enumeration for the remaining country is likely to begin in February next year, barring snow-bound regions, during which data on various demographic, socio-cultural and economic parameters, along with migration and fertility characteristics of individuals from each household, will be collected.

The terms of the state Assemblies of Goa, Manipur, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand will end by May 2027, and they are likely to go to polls early next year.

A wide range of government servants, primarily teachers, are engaged in the Census exercise and elections, which makes it difficult to conduct the two exercises simultaneously, an official said.

The central government has also deferred the house-listing operations for Census 2027 for Manipur, another notification issued by RGI on Saturday said.

The Census, the eighth since independence, is being conducted in two phases -- the first stage is known as house listing and housing census, and the second is population enumeration.

The decennial exercise, scheduled for 2021, was postponed due to the COVID-19 outbreak. The Union Cabinet has approved Rs 11,718 crore for conducting the Census, which will be the biggest headcount exercise.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Nepal flood toll rises, around 5,000 missing

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Kathmandu, September 5

The death toll from the devastating flash floods in Nepal surged to 1,344 on Saturday as more bodies were recovered from the affected areas, according to Nepal Police.

Rescue teams continued to search for around 5,000 people, including at least 589 foreign nationals, who remain missing, while more than 13,100 people have been rescued, officials said.

Among those rescued on Saturday was a 60-year-old woman who was pulled out alive from the top floor of a four-storey house, where she was trapped for 10 days, buried under mud and debris after the floods, in Bidur town in Nepal's Nuwakot district.

Her family had performed symbolic last rites assuming she was dead, after they could not find her for several days following the disaster.

The woman, Chandika Shrestha, was found unconscious by an Armed Police Force (APF) team, and flown to the Nepali Army's Maithili Barracks in Trishuli for treatment. She will be flown to Kathmandu for further medical treatment, said APF deputy spokesperson Shailendra Thapa.

The flash floods, triggered by an ice-rock avalanche near the Nepal-Tibet border on August 26, devastated towns and villages in northern and central Nepal.

The Bhotekoshi River, which flows south from the Himalayan border region, carried the floodwaters downstream, sweeping away homes, vehicles, roads and bridges and damaging hydropower projects.

The disaster also killed at least 21 people on the Chinese side, while more than 500 people remain missing in Tibet, according to Chinese media reports.

Of the total bodies recovered in Nepal so far, 85 were children, while 501 were found with body parts missing, officials said, attributing the condition of the bodies to prolonged exposure to water and the weight of debris.

As many as 360 bodies were recovered in Chitwan alone, the highest among all districts. The rest were from Nawalparasi East, Nawalparasi West, Nuwakot, Rasuwa, Gorkha, Dhading and Tanahun districts, according to Nepal's National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA).

Only 98 bodies have been handed over to families so far after identification, according to NDRRMA.

Identifying the dead has emerged as a major challenge. Bodies recovered after being swept downstream have often been severely damaged, decomposed or recovered only in parts, making identification by face, clothing or personal belongings difficult, officials said.

CBI FIR puts...

Pan India Infra Projects Private Limited as the co-borrower, and a Rs 480-crore facility extended to Digital Subscriber Management and Consultancy Services Private Limited, with Spirit Infra Power and Multi Ventures Private Limited as the co-borrower.

According to the complaint, the Rs 500-crore Vasant Sagar facility was sanctioned as a home-entity loan for takeover, top-up and business expansion, and secured by a continuing guarantee dated March 28, 2018, executed by Chandra.

The Rs 480-crore digital facility was sanctioned as a rental-discounting facility under a rental-securitisation scheme through a different loan account, and secured by a continuing guarantee, also executed by Chandra, the FIR alleges.

According to the lender, the net-worth certification submitted by Chandra was issued by DJM and Co. on March 28, 2018, certifying his net worth to be at around Rs 59,000 crore.

The LICHFL has said the digital facility was sanctioned partly on the basis of a net-worth certificate submitted by Chandra, issued by chartered accountants MPJ and Co. on July 6, 2018. The certificate had put his net worth at Rs 40,562 crore.

The two loans subsequently went into default, according to the LICHFL. The FIR says during the subsequent proceedings under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016, Chandra denied having the net worth stated in the certificates submitted to the LICHFL.

During the proceedings, the noted industrialist pegged his net worth in 2024 to be at Rs 31.79 crore and in 2017-18, at no more than Rs 40,000 crore, the FIR says.

"Subhash Chandra had thus, acting in collusion with the borrowers, Vasant Sagar Properties Pvt. Ltd, Pan India Infraprojects Pvt. Ltd, Digital Subscriber Management and Consultancy Services Pvt. Ltd, and Spirit Infrapower and Multiventures Pvt. Ltd and their officers and directors, defrauded and cheated LICHFL into advancing the loans to the borrower entities, which have since misappropriated the same," the FIR alleges.

It accuses the former Rajya Sabha MP of creating false documents to denote inflated and false net worth to cheat the LICHFL into deploying funds to the principal borrowers.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Briefs

Complete failure of govt: Rahul

NEW DELHI: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Saturday said the deaths of several tribal children due to various diseases in Madhya Pradesh's Balaghat district show a complete failure of the BJP government in the state and urged the chief minister to personally resolve the issue.

In a post on X, the leader of opposition in the Lok Sabha said the news of 30 tribal children dying in Balaghat is extremely alarming and heartbreaking.

"The lack of basic facilities, such as drinking water, nutrition and timely treatment, is claiming the lives of the children who are suffering due to this deadly disease," Gandhi said.

Jaishankar to address UNGA session

UNITED NATIONS: External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar will address the annual high-level UN General Assembly session on September 26.

The 81st session of the UN General Assembly will kick-off on September 8, and world leaders will address the 193-member organisation at the General Debate, which will run from September 22 to 28.

Jaishankar is scheduled to address the General Debate in the afternoon session on September 26, according to a revised provisional list of speakers for the high-level session released here Friday.

SAD women's wing holds protest

CHANDIGARH: The Shiromani Akali Dal held a protest on Saturday here against Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann's wife, Gurpreet Kaur, over allegations that she sought Rs 5 crore to suppress a rape case, demanding the registration of an FIR against her.

Kaur rejected the charges, terming them "baseless". Several women Akali leaders, including SAD MP and former union minister Harsimrat Kaur Badal and Akali MLA Ganieve Kaur Majithia, were detained.

UNION TERRITORY OF LADAKH

MHA official reviews deregulation framework

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Patna, September 5

A senior Union Home Ministry official on Saturday reviewed issues related to deregulation, delegation of powers under the citizenship and immigration framework, implementation of the Immigration and Foreigners Act, and the progress of various flagship programmes in the Union Territory of Ladakh.

The review meeting, chaired by Additional Secretary (Foreigners and UT) Nitesh Vyas from the Ministry of Home Affairs, included the Chief Secretary of UT Ladakh, Ashish Kundra, along with administrative secretaries and senior officials from the UT administration, an official spokesman said.

Discussions covered the progress and implementation of various centrally sponsored schemes and flagship programmes in the region. A detailed review was conducted on the implementation status of Points of Action under deregulation 1.0 and 2.0.

Category-wise PAs, their respective numbers, and implementation statuses were discussed with the relevant departments, along with necessary follow-up actions for speedy implementation, the spokesman noted.

The meeting also discussed the regulatory

KEY POINTS

» Discussions covered the progress and implementation of various centrally sponsored schemes and flagship programmes in the region

» The disaster management department stated that 2.32 lakh people were hit by floods in Patna, one of the worst-affected districts

» The review also covered the Immigration and Foreigners Order, 2025, focusing on facilitation, connectivity, and procedures, including the establishment and operation of tourist facilitation centres

framework governing Protected Areas and Restricted Areas, including the legal provisions under the 2025 framework.

It was clarified that domestic tourists do not need an Inner Line Permit; however, permits remain mandatory for notified areas as outlined in the applicable regulations.

Discussions were held on defining the geographic scope of protected and restricted areas, including their delineation through separate schedules, protected area boundaries, and relevant descriptions.

The status of restricted areas concerning Tibetan settlements was also reviewed, the spokesperson said, adding that the meeting included discussions on the framework governing the issuance of Protected Area Permits and Restricted Area Permits, as well as visa-related amendments.

Follow-up action on the demarcation of the Nubra and Sham regions, as well as the demarcation of Kargil and Changthang regions, was discussed along with the applicable regulatory framework, he said.

The review also covered the Immigration and Foreigners Order, 2025, focusing on facilitation, connectivity, and procedures, including the establishment and operation of tourist facilitation centres.

A comprehensive review of the Immigration and Foreigners framework was undertaken, covering the Foreigners Act, the evolution of immigration laws and the subordinate framework under the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025-26.

The meeting also discussed the decentralisation of powers under Section 28, including delegation of powers to States and Union

Territory Administrations.

Various actions required from the UT Administration were reviewed, including the registration of foreigners, monitoring and regulating the movement of foreigners within the UT, enforcing deportation guidelines, and addressing issues related to overstaying foreigners.

Additionally, the meeting discussed matters concerning foreigners' registration under Section 6, monitoring their movement in states/UTs, illegal migrants, holding centres, and the deportation manual, as well as a Model Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for withdrawal from prosecution.

The architecture of the District Police Module, objectives and target demographic of the Foreigner Identification Portal (FIP), registration through the e-FRRO portal, and actionable points for Foreigners Registration Officers (FROs) were reviewed, the spokesperson informed.

The meeting also reviewed progress regarding the granting of Indian citizenship, which included the legal provisions governing Indian citizenship, relevant sections of the Citizenship Act, and the procedures for granting Indian citizenship, the spokesperson added.

Supreme Court judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan on Friday expressed concern over the alleged assault of protesters by police personnel during the recent NEET students' protest at Jantar Mantar, saying the detachment expected of police officers appears to be disappearing.

Speaking at the launch

Childhood best time to instil good conduct: Prez Murmu

The president made the comments in her address at the National Teachers' Award ceremony

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 5

School education forms the foundation of the education system, as knowledge and skills can be acquired at any time, but teaching good conduct during childhood is far more effective, President Droupadi Murmu said on Saturday.

The President made the comments in her address at the National Teachers' Award ceremony on the occasion of Teachers' Day.

"By diligently focusing on the intellectual, physical, and moral development of children in the early grades, our teachers can prepare future generations of excellent students and dutiful citizens."

"School education forms the foundation of the education system. While knowledge and



President Murmu confers National Award to a teacher during an event on Teacher's Day, in New Delhi PTI

skills can be acquired at any time, imparting lessons in good conduct during childhood proves far more effective," she said.

President Murmu highlighted that education is the most effective means of realising the ideal of equality of opportunity enshrined in our Constitution. She praised teachers for achieving a negligible primary school dropout rate.

The president acknowledged that many students come from economically disadvantaged backgrounds, with some being first-generation learners. Others transition from small village schools to large urban institutions, while some may be shy or very talented but lacking in self-confidence.

Additionally, there are children with special needs.

'Police detachment disappearing'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 5

Supreme Court judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan on Friday expressed concern over the alleged assault of protesters by police personnel during the recent NEET students' protest at Jantar Mantar, saying the detachment expected of police officers appears to be disappearing.

Speaking at the launch

of former secretary (security) Yashovardhan Azad's book "Policing the Republic", Justice Bhuyan said, "All of us are dismayed when we see young officers of the Indian Police Service personally going and assaulting protesters and demonstrators. This is something very, very distressing to observe."

"The detachment expected of police officers somehow seems to be disappearing, and this

is indeed a matter of grave concern," he added.

The book launch was held at Viceroy Hall in the national capital. Congress MP P Chidambaram, former Maharashtra DGP D Sivanandhan and others were present at the event.

Justice Bhuyan said that effective policing could be done without resorting to the excessive use of force or infringement of human rights.

CM Saini: 250 schools to be developed as CM-EEE schools

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 5

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini announced that from the upcoming academic session, teachers associated with higher education, technical education, and technology education will also be honoured with the State Teacher Award. Currently, this award is conferred only upon teachers associated with school education.

He added that it is the government's priority to encourage all teachers who make outstanding contributions to the field of education. CM Saini made this announcement while addressing the state level function on Teachers' Day held in Panchkula on Saturday as a distinguished guest. Haryana Governor Professor Ashim Kumar Ghosh, the Chief Guest, Governor Mitra Ghosh and



Education minister Mahipal Dhanda were also present.

On the occasion, Governor Professor Ashim Kumar Ghosh, Chief Minister Saini and Education minister Dhanda honored 79 teachers for their outstanding contribution to the field of education.

Meanwhile, The Haryana govt has taken in-principle decision to bring sanitation workers working on municipal rolls under the ambit of the Haryana Contractual Employees (Service Security) Act, 2024.

Saharanpur collectorate mosque demolished

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, September 5

A mosque located inside the Saharanpur collectorate complex was demolished on Saturday morning amid tight security, days after a district court upheld an order declaring the structure illegal.

The administration sealed all five gates of the collectorate premises before the demolition and barred entry to outsiders.

A heavy police force, including personnel from the Rapid Action Force (RAF), was deployed at the site and in surrounding areas to maintain law and order.

JCB machines, dumpers and other equipment had been brought into the collectorate premises during the night.

The demolition began early Saturday morning and the mosque was subsequently razed.

Punjab ranked 27 in education in 2021, now its on top: CM

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 5

Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Saturday pointed out his government's education reforms have transformed Punjab's government school system, with the state moving from 27 rank in education in 2021 to No 1 in primary education, while announcing the government's vision to make Punjab a global education hub.

During a state-level Teachers' Day function in Mohali, the Chief Minister highlighted international training for teachers, 118 Schools of Eminence, Wi-Fi connectivity in 16,348 schools, Business Blasters and stronger parent participation through PTMs as key drivers of the transformation, while also honouring 50 teachers for their outstanding services.

Sharing a few snippets on X, CM Mann stated, "Today, at the state-level



Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann MPOST

event held in Mohali on the occasion of Teachers' Day, paid tribute to Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan and honoured teachers who have rendered outstanding services.

"Taking the education sector to greater heights is our top priority. International training for teachers, the establishment of 118 Schools of Eminence (SoE), and providing Wi-Fi facilities in 16,348 schools are important steps taken in this direction," Mann said.

He added, through the Business Blasters pro-

gramme, we are empowering students to become not job seekers, but job creators. Let us work together to build an educated, skilled and 'Rangla Punjab'. Inquilab Zindabad."

Addressing the gathering during the state-level Teachers' Day function in Mohali, Mann said, "My dream is to make Punjab a global education hub. Due to the revolutionary steps taken by our government in the education sector, the day is not far when teachers from across the world will come to Punjab to receive training."

Regulation enabling HC bench in Ladakh comes into effect

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Leh, September 5

The regulation for a permanent bench of the Jammu and Kashmir High Court in Ladakh came into effect on Saturday, with Lt Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena describing its implementation as a "historic step" towards bringing the justice delivery system closer to the people.

The regulation, promulgated by the President of India on August 27, 2026, provided that it shall come into force on such date as the Administrator may, by notification in the Official Gazette, appoint.

"The Union Territory of Ladakh (sitting of Bench of the High Court of Jammu and Kashmir in Ladakh) Regulation, 2026, which provides for a Bench of the High Court of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh to sit in the Union Territory of Ladakh, has come into force today (Saturday) onwards," an official spokesman said.

It will facilitate further action for establishing and operationalising the Bench, including consultation with the High Court of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh and the departments concerned on the required judicial, administrative, infrastructural, financial and logistical arrangements, he said.

The establishment of a High Court Bench in Ladakh is expected to significantly improve access to justice for the people of the Union Territory, particularly litigants from remote and far-flung areas.

CJP raises questions over police action

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Kolkata, September 5

At a press conference held in Kolkata on Saturday, the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) raised serious questions regarding the functioning of the police and administration in connection with the alleged murder of party volunteer Abdul Hafiz's father.

The CJP stated that the organisation wants to meet the Chief Secretary of West Bengal to present its key demands. However, if the meeting does not take place by September 7, CJP would gherao the office of the DM,

Bankura, on September 8.

CJP also raised questions regarding the arrest of one of the accused in the murder case. According to the organisation, Hafiz had identified the said accused on August 25 itself. Despite this, CJP alleges that the person organised a programme in front of Indus Police Station on the day of Raksha Bandhan under police protection, yet the police have still not arrested him. "If an identified accused can move around publicly and still remains free, how can the common people expect justice from such administration?", CJP questioned.

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Bathinda, September 5

Punjab's flagship sporting initiative, 'Khedan Wattan Punjab Diyan-2026', began from Bathinda on Saturday, with CM Bhagwant Singh Mann setting an ambitious vision of taking Punjab's sporting talent to the global stage.

The fourth season will bring nearly 10 lakh players aged 14 to over 70 years into 39 sporting disciplines, including four para-sports, while connecting generations and nurturing talent from villages

CLOSER LOOK

» The fourth season will bring nearly 10 lakh players aged 14 to over 70 years into 39 sporting disciplines

» Opening ceremony featured vibrant cultural performances, including Bhangra and Giddha, showcasing the state's rich heritage and its deep-rooted connection with sports'

and cities across the state. The event will conclude in Patiala on November 29, with Rs 12.50 crore in prize money for winners, including cash awards for veteran players for the first time.

On the occasion, CM Mann also honoured Com-

monwealth Games-2026 silver medallists Harjinder Kaur and Lovepreet Singh with Rs 50 lakh each, reaffirming the state government's commitment to building a strong sporting ecosystem and providing Punjab's youth with oppor-

tunities to excel.

The fourth season of 'Khedan Wattan Punjab Diyan-2026' began with great fervour and enthusiasm at Shaheed Bhagat Singh Stadium, Bathinda, celebrating Punjab's rich sporting and cultural spirit.

The opening ceremony featured vibrant cultural performances, including Bhangra and Giddha, showcasing the state's rich heritage and its deep-rooted connection with sports.

Legendary Punjabi artist Gurdas Maan, and

Kulwinder Billa also performed at the ceremony, adding to the grandeur and festive atmosphere of the mega sporting event.

The celebrations were further marked by a symbolic moment as CM Mann and legendary Gurdas Maan jointly released colourful balloons into the sky, formally commemorating the beginning of the fourth season.

The ceremony brought together Punjab's sporting passion, cultural heritage and youthful energy in a vibrant celebration.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURKSHA SANHITA

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused Persons Namley **1.Mofil S/o** Md. Kasim **R/o** Gali No. 4, Near Fatima Masjid, 33 Fda Road, Kabir Nagar, Welcome, Delhi. **2.Akhar S/o** Md. Yakub **R/o** Rahis Ka Makan near Fatima Masjid, Kabir Nagar, Delhi, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 763/2023 U/s 12/09/55 Gambling Act.**, has been registered at **PS: Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **1.Mofil 2.Akhar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **1.Mofil 2.Akhar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused said, **1. Mofil 2.Akhar of FIR No. 763/2023 U/s 12/09/55 Gambling Act.**, has been registered at **PS: Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.10.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Deepakshi Rana

JMFC-03, Room No. 19

Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/10725/NE/2026

(court notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Md. Nasir @ Lalla S/o** Nasruddin **R/o** E-197, Jai Bharti Camp, Jhuggi East Vinod Nagar, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 0010334/2022 U/S 379/411 IPC, PS Daryaganj, Central Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Md. Nasir @ Lalla** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Md. Nasir @ Lalla** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Md. Nasir @ Lalla** the said accused of **FIR No. 0010334/2022 U/S 379/411 IPC, PS Daryaganj, Central Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.10.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Nidhi Bala

Judicial Magistrate First Class-05,

Central Distt., Court No. 241,

Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/12552/CD/2026

(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Big Jos Joseph, S/o.: Yoha, R/o.: H. No.: 95, U/S/F, Khasra No. 25/23/2, Chander Vihar, Nilotthi Extn., Nihal Vihar Outer District, Delhi** and Also at **Ghana Africa** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.63/2023 Dt.22.08.2023 U/S 419/420/120B/34 IPC** registered at **P.S. Cyber, Outer District, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said accused **Big Jos Joseph** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Big Jos Joseph** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Big Jos Joseph**, accused of **FIR No. 63/2023 Dt.22.08.2023 U/S 419/420/120B/34 IPC, P.S. Cyber, Outer District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.10.2026**.

By Order, Ms. Vasundhara Azad

Chief Judicial Magistrate (West District),

Room No.146, First Floor,

Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/12564/OD/2026

(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No: 20-Elect/G/PRY/J/2627

Dated: 03.09.2026

E-Tender Notice

Senior Divl. Electrical Engineer/Gen/N. C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following e-Tenders on prescribed form for the following works up to 15:00 hrs. on 25.09.2026 The details of the tenders are as under:-

SN.: 1

TN.: ELG-50-2627

Cost of work (in ₹): ₹ 3.33,06,791.02

Name of work: Operation and Security of 33/11 KV Sub-Stations over Prayagraj division for two years.

Bid Security(in ₹): ₹ 6.66,100.00

Duration of completion: 24 Month

SN.: 2

TN.: ELG-51-2627

Cost of work (in ₹): ₹ 1,91,58,580.94

Name of work: Electrical work in connection with "Provision of 12m wide FOB at Sonbhadra, Firozabad, Shikohabad, & Mainpuri stations under Amrit Bharat Station Scheme of Prayagraj Division.

Bid Security(in ₹): ₹ 3.83,200.00

Duration of completion: 06 Month

Tender Opening Date: 25.09.2026, 15:00 Hrs.

Note:- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above e-Tender is available on Website www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 hrs. on the due date of tender opening. 2037/26(AK)

North central railways

@CPRONCR

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli

E-Tender Notice no.- ELECT-PS-20595

On behalf of the President of India, Dy., Chief Electrical Engineer/PS, Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli is inviting open e-tender, based on single packet system from capable & experienced tenderers through Indian Railways portal www.ireps.gov.in for the under mentioned work on prescribed tender format.

Details:- 1. Name of Work: Alternate power supply arrangement for FWP from 33/11KV Substation of MCF. 2. Place of work: Modern Coach Factory Lalganj, Distt. Raebareli. 3. Approx. cost: Rs. 2,48,90,382.87 (Two Crore Forty Eight Lakh Ninety Thousand Three Hundred Eighty Two Rupees And Eighty Seven Paise Only). 4. Earnest money: Rs. 4,97,800.00 (Four Lakh Ninety Seven Thousand Eight Hundred Rupees Only). 5. Period of completion: 09 (Nine) months. 6. Date & Time of closing of tender: 22.09.2026 at 15.00 hrs. 7. Term & Condition: Other details, terms & condition are available in tender documents on www.ireps.gov.in.

E-Tender Notice No. 05/2026-27 (Open) of DyCE-II/MCF/RBL - Corrigendum

With reference to E-Tender Notice No.-05/2026-27 (Open) of DyCE-II/MCF/RBL, it is hereby informed that the tender no. is modified as under:

Particulars

Existing Tender No.

Modified Tender No.

Tender No.

10-2026-27

10-2026-27-RT

Deputy Chief Engineer-II

SERVICE CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

T. Notice No. 230-Elect/TRD/PRY/J/E-Tender Notice/2026/654

Date : 02.09.2026

E- Tender Notice

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/N. C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under:-

Tender No.: 230-TRD-WC-1043-2026, Description of work: 25kV OHE modification work due to construction of RUB at LC-13 in Bhawari yard & CTR(S) works in Prayagraj Division (2nd Call).

Advertised Value : ₹ 82.79,536.52

Bid Security : 1.65,600.00

Completion Period : 12 Months

Bidding System : Single Packet

Tender Closing Date & Time : 25.09.2026 & 14:00 Hrs.

Tender Opening Date & Time : 25.09.2026 & 15:00 Hrs.

Note:- (1) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website www.ireps.gov.in 21days prior to the date of opening of the tender. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. (3) In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 2028/26 (MG)

North central railways

@CPRONCR

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli

E-Tender Notice no.- ELECT-PS-20595

On behalf of the President of India, Dy., Chief Electrical Engineer/PS, Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli is inviting open e-tender, based on single packet system from capable & experienced tenderers through Indian Railways portal www.ireps.gov.in for the under mentioned work on prescribed tender format.

Details:- 1. Name of Work: Alternate power supply arrangement for FWP from 33/11KV Substation of MCF. 2. Place of work: Modern Coach Factory Lalganj, Distt. Raebareli. 3. Approx. cost: Rs. 2,48,90,382.87 (Two Crore Forty Eight Lakh Ninety Thousand Three Hundred Eighty Two Rupees And Eighty Seven Paise Only). 4. Earnest money: Rs. 4,97,800.00 (Four Lakh Ninety Seven Thousand Eight Hundred Rupees Only). 5. Period of completion: 09 (Nine) months. 6. Date & Time of closing of tender: 22.09.2026 at 15.00 hrs. 7. Term & Condition: Other details, terms & condition are available in tender documents on www.ireps.gov.in.

E-Tender Notice No. 05/2026-27 (Open) of DyCE-II/MCF/RBL - Corrigendum

With reference to E-Tender Notice No.-05/2026-27 (Open) of DyCE-II/MCF/RBL, it is hereby informed that the tender no. is modified as under:

Particulars

Existing Tender No.

Modified Tender No.

Tender No.

10-2026-27

10-2026-27-RT

Deputy Chief Engineer-II

SERVICE CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Udaiveer @ Keshav, S/o Kalu Ram R/o G-408, Jahangir Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.447/2023 u/s 356/379/34 IPC, P.S. Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Udaiveer @ Keshav** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Udaiveer @ Keshav** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Udaiveer @ Keshav of FIR No.447/2023 u/s 356/379/34 IPC, P.S. Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.10.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Sahil Gupta

Judicial Magistrate First Class-07 (North), Court No. 6, Ground Floor

Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/12490/ON/2026

UJVN LIMITED

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006

Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508

CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Tender Cancellation Notice

Date: 5/09/2026

Letter No: 778

The invited e-Tender No. 11/ EE(Civil) / MB-II / Chinyalisaur / 2026-27 invited by Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil), Maneri Bhali Stage-II, Chinyalisaur, Uttarkashi is hereby cancelled due to inevitable reason.

Executive Engineer (Civil)

MB-II Chinyalisaur,Uttarkashi

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),

email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice

Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Muneesh Singh alias Joti alias Deepak S/O Nihar Singh R/O House No. 67, Sanjay Nagar, Jammu is evading his arrest / wanted in case FIR No. 252/2002 U/S 379 RPC, of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/ still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name

: Muneesh Singh alias Joti alias Deepak

S/O

: Nihar Singh

Address

: House No. 67, Sanjay Nagar, Jammu

Age

: 45-50 Years

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu

: 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578

2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D

: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

3.PCR Jammu

: 0191-2605949

4.SP City South

: 0191-2430002

5.SDPO City East

: 0191 2433778

6.P/S Bahu Fort

: 0191-2475133

Sd/-

Superintendent of Police

Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-9551/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person (1) **Bal Kishan, S/o: Hardwari Lal, R/o: H.No. 221 Shahbad Daulatpur, Delhi** (2) **Chandan Kashyan, S/o: Balveer Singh, R/o: Gali No. 08 Village Shahbad Daulatpur Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** (3) **Sheikh Miraj, S/o: Sheikh Atiya, R/o: Gali No. 08 Village Shahbad Daulatpur Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case Reg No: 10764/2022, FIR No. 601/2021, U/s: 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) (1) **Bal Kishan** (2) **Chandan Kashyan** (3) **Sheikh Miraj**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) (1) **Bal Kishan** (2) **Chandan Kashyan** (3) **Sheikh Miraj**, has absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person (1) **Bal Kishan** (2) **Chandan Kashyan** (3) **Sheikh Miraj**, of **Case Reg No: 10764/2022, FIR No. 601/2021, U/s: 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.10.2026**.

By Order

Bharti Beniwal

Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North)

Court Room No. 114, 1st Floor

Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/12342/ON/2026

(Court Matter)

UJVN LIMITED

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)

H. O. "UJJWAL", MAHARANI BAGH, GMS ROAD, DEHRADUN - 248006, CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866

Tele.: 0135-2763508, 2763008, Fax: 0135-2763507, Website: www.ujvnl.com

Tender No.777

Date : 05.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

For and on behalf of UJVN Ltd, Executive Engineer (Civil), Pashulok Barrage Rishikesh, invites sealed & separate tender from interested contractors for following work:-

1.Tender Notice Reference: NIT No.14/2026-27/EE(C)/Pashulok Barrage:-

Miscellaneous Civil M&R Works in the office of EE (E&M) at Pashulok, Rishikesh.

2. Estimated Value of Tender: ₹ 9.94,662.13(excluding GST).

3. Date of availability of bid : 07 September, 2026 from 13:00 Hrs. (IST). document on website

4. Last Date for Submission of Tender: 28 September, 2026 upto 13:00 Hrs. (IST). For fuller&further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com"

Executive Engineer (Civil) Pashulok Barrage, Rishikesh

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

T. Notice No. 230-Elect/TRD/PRY/J/E-Tender Notice/2026/654

Date : 02.09.2026

E- Tender Notice

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/N. C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under:-

Tender No.: 230-TRD-WC-1043-2026, Description of work: 25kV OHE modification work due to construction of RUB at LC-13 in Bhawari yard & CTR(S) works in Prayagraj Division (2nd Call).

Advertised Value : ₹ 82.79,536.52

Bid Security : 1.65,600.00

Completion Period : 12 Months

Bidding System : Single Packet

Tender Closing Date & Time : 25.09.2026 & 14:00 Hrs.

Tender Opening Date & Time : 25.09.2026 & 15:00 Hrs.

Note:- (1) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website www.ireps.gov.in 21days prior to the date of opening of the tender. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. (3) In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 2028/26 (MG)

North central railways

@CPRONCR

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURKSHA SANHITA

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Suraj @ Arjun S/o** Badri Prasad **R/o** A-126, Harkesh Nagar, Okhla Phase-2, New Delhi & also at: Vill. Khojapur, Post-Retimalipur, PS-Dhullapur, Distt-Ghazipur, UP, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 114/2026 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act.**, has been registered at **PS: Okhla Ind. Area, New Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Suraj @ Arjun** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Suraj @ Arjun** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Suraj @ Arjun of under FIR No. 114/2026 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act.**, Registered at: **PS: Okhla Ind. Area, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.10.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Akansha Gautam

Ld. JMFC-02 (South East), Room No. 513

Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/12581/SE/2026

(Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Kamal Sehgal S/o** Raj Kumar Sehgal **R/o** WZ-12, 1st Floor, Tanna Tan Wali Gali, Uttam Nagar, Delhi, **Also at:** 1st Floor, C-47, Arogya Appartment, Sector-7, Dwarka, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 60/11, U/S 4/5 ITP Act, PS Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Kamal Sehgal** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Kamal Sehgal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Kamal Sehgal** the said accused of **FIR No. 60/11, U/S 4/5 ITP Act, PS Bhajanpura, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.10.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Kirandeep Kaur

Judicial Magistrate First Class-01,

Court No. 05, 2nd Floor, North-East Distt.,

Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/12626/NE/2026

(Court Matter)

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),

email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice

Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Amandeep Singh alias AD S/O Balvinder Singh R/O House No. 16, Sector No. 03 Modal Town Gangyal, Jammu is evading his arrest / wanted in case FIR No. 64/2021 U/S 307/341 IPC, 4/25 Arms Act of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name

: Amandeep Singh alias AD

S/O

: Balvinder Singh

Address

: House No. 16, Sector No. 03 Modal Town Gangyal, Jammu

Age

: 25-30 years

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu

: 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578

2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D

: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

3.PCR Jammu

: 0191-2605949

4.SP City South

: 0191-2430002

5.SDPO City East

: 0191 2433778

6.P/S Bahu Fort

: 0191-2475133

Sd/-

Superintendent of Police

Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-9554/26

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),

email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice

Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Bakshi Nagar, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Sandeep Kumar S/O Darshan Lal R/O R/O 450 Krishna Nagar, Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 170/2021 U/S 457/80/411 RPC of P/S Bakshi Nagar, Jammu, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name

: Sandeep Kumar

S/O

: Darshan Lal

Address

: 450 Krishna Nagar, Jammu

Heigh

: 5' 06"

Complexion

: Wheatish

Eyes

: Black

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu

: 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578

2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D

: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

3.PCR Jammu

: 0191-2605949

4.SP City North

: 0191-2547038

5.SDPO City West

: 0191-2580251

6.P/S Bakshi Nagar

: 0191-2580102

Sd/-

Superintendent of Police

Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-9557/26

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),

email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice

Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Suraj Singh S/O Bhero Singh R/O Nai Basti, Gorkha Nagar, Jammu is evading his arrest / wanted in case FIR No. 185/1996 U/S 307/341/34 IPC, 4/25 Arms Act of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/ still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name

: Suraj Singh

S/O

: Bhero Singh

Address

: Nai Basti, Gorkha Nagar, Jammu

Age

: 55-60 years

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu

: 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578

2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D

: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

3.PCR Jammu

: 0191-2605949

4.SP City South

: 0191-2430002

5.SDPO City East

: 0191 2433778

6.P/S Bahu Fort

: 0191-2475133

Sd/-

Superintendent of Police

Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-9555/26

HQ District Police, Ramban

dpo.ramban12@jkpolice.gov.in

NO:-CB/Hue & Cry Notice/2026/49321-50

Dated:- 03 - 09-2026

HUE AND CRY NOTICE

As intimated by SDPO Gool vide communication No. SDG/2026/4067 Dated 03-09-2026, that the accused person namely Anwar Hussain S/o Malik Hussain R/O Ward No. 05 Kadyal, Tehsil R.S. Pura, District Jammu, involved in case FIR No. 39/2026 U/S 105/238/211/3(5) BNS & 8/21/22 NDPS Act of Police Station Gool, is evading his arrest after committing the offences. The Photograph and Description of absconding accused is as under:-

Description Role

Name :-

Anwar Hussain

D/O:-

Malik Hussain

R/O:-

Ward No. 05 Kadyal

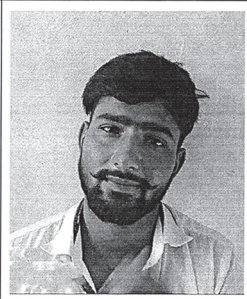
Tehsil RS Pura District Jammu.

Complexion:

Fair

Other Particulars:

Oval to round face, with Straight black hair and Prominent eyebrows and Moustache.



It is therefore requested that a sharp lookout may kindly be maintained in your respective jurisdictions, if any due regarding the whereabouts of absconding accused person be struck out, immediate information may kindly be shared on the below mentioned E-mail/Phone numbers. E-mail ID: dpo.ramban12@jkpolice.gov. in, PCR Ramban:- 9906926079, 9906925595. SDPO Gool:- 9596587639 SHO P/S Gool:- 7006275170.

Sd/-Arun Gupta -JKPS

Sr. Superintendent of Police,

Ramban.

DIP No:DIP/J-9525/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Mithlesh S/o** Kailash Yadav, R/o H. No. 208/209 Pocket-4, JJ Colony Bindapur, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 019679/2022 U/s 411 IPC, PS Hari Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Mithlesh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mithlesh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Mithlesh** in **FIR No. 019679/2022 U/s 411 IPC, PS Hari Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.10.2026**.

By order

Ms. Moksha Bains

Judicial Magistrate First Class-II

West, Court No. 31

Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/12452/NDD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Ram Niwas S/o** Sh.Govind **R/o** Vill. Nangla Kheda, PO-Udeser, Distt-Firozabad, UP also at: H.No. 885, Sec-05, Pushp Vihar, Malviya Nagar, Delhi, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **CR No. 13223/2018 U/s 138 NI Act.**, has been registered at **PS: South Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Ram Niwas** namely cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Ram Niwas** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Ram Niwas** of under **CR No. 13223/2018 U/s 138 NI Act.**, Registered at: **PS: South Rohini, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.10.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Aakansha

JMFC-03, Room No. 127

Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/12595/RD/2026

(Court Notice)

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),

email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice

Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Bakshi Nagar, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Mukul S/O Bharat Bhushan R/O 459 Krishna Nagar, Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 89/2021 U/S 363 IPC , of P/S Bakshi Nagar, Jammu, since the

SAYS NAVY SHIPS WERE TARGETED WITH MISSILES

US military hits 3 Iranian oil tankers

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Cairo, September 5

US forces struck three Iranian oil tankers after Navy warships were targeted with missiles, the American military said Saturday, warning that it would “if necessary, destroy Iran’s limited and exposed oil fleet.”

The strikes – a day after US President Donald Trump sought to minimise the conflict as “small potatoes” – keep up a new tilt back toward fighting after six months of on-again, off-again war that began with US and Israeli attacks on the country on February 28. Both sides have sought to inflict both military and economic pain, and negotiations have collapsed.

The military’s statement said that an American aircraft carrier and a destroyer evaded “multiple unprovoked Iranian attacks”



Teen girl wounded during a strike what Iranian media said was a US strike lies on the bed in a hospital in town of Minab in southern Iran, Saturday

while patrolling in the region and no US personnel were hurt. It said that two Iranian oil carriers were “permanently disabled” and the third, unladen one, was destroyed.

The US statement said that the tankers were part of a shadow network helping to fund Iran’s powerful

Revolutionary Guard and its armed proxies in the region.

There was no immediate Iranian response.

Earlier, Iranian state television had said that four US missiles struck a tanker about 6 miles (10 kilometres) from Kharg Island, home to a terminal through

which the country exports most of its oil. Kharg Island has been repeatedly targeted during the war, including US strikes on military sites there in March.

The US said that one tanker was struck off Kharg Island and another was struck near Jask, east of the Strait of Hormuz. The

unladen tanker was hit in the Gulf of Oman, and the US said its crew had been “directed to abandon ship.” The statement shared what it called video footage of the strikes.

After the US statement, Iran’s state broadcaster reported the two other tankers attacked, saying their crews had evacuated. “We will not hesitate to defend American forces, and if necessary, destroy Iran’s limited and exposed oil fleet,” said Adm. Brad Cooper, the head of US Central Command.

The strikes came nearly a week after the US and Iran resumed attacks following a month of relative calm, with the Strait of Hormuz and Iranian communities along it again being targeted. At least five people were killed earlier in the week during a US bombardment of southern Iran. One strike hit a wedding.

US envoy visits Palestinian town amid West Bank unrest

AGENCIES
Turmus Ayya, September 5

US Ambassador to Israel Mike Huckabee on Saturday met with Palestinian Americans, including relatives of US citizens killed by Israeli settlers, in a Palestinian town in the occupied West Bank that has been the target of settler attacks.

Reuters reported that the visit comes as settler violence, and what is widely perceived as the Israeli government’s inaction, has increasingly drawn international condemnation, including from US allies.

The Israeli government has condemned settler violence, though perpetrators are rarely arrested and even less frequently prosecuted.

Washington has not criticised Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu’s government over the violence, though has called for perpetrators to be prosecuted with Huckabee labelling them as terrorists.

Huckabee described his meeting in Turmus Ayya, where most of the town’s Palestinian residents are US citizens, as constructive.

While Huckabee, a Baptist minister and long-time supporter of Israeli settlements, has previously called for violent settlers to be prosecuted, he also says he believes they represent a minority of the settler community, which numbers around 750,000.

Around three million Palestinians live in the West Bank, with tens of thousands estimated to be American citizens.

Palestinians in the West Bank have faced a surge in settler violence while their freedoms have been increasingly curtailed under military occupation since Netanyahu’s coalition, the most right wing in Israel’s history, came to power in late 2022.

In Turmus Ayya, Palestinians are facing what Mayor Nawwaf Zaghoul said were constant settler attacks.

About 80 per cent of the Palestinian town’s residents hold US citizenship, he said.

PUBLIC NOTICE
My clients, Mr. Ravi Babu and his wife Mrs. Seema Rani Malhotra-residents of 348, Bhai Parmanand Colony, Dr. Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi-110009-have severed all ties with and disinherited their son, Mohit Malhotra, and daughter-in-law, Aashna, from their movable and immovable property due to their misconduct and ill-treatment. Anyone entering into any transaction or relationship with them in the future shall be solely responsible for the consequences.
Sd/- Satyam Dev Vardhan
Advocate
B-49X, DDA Flats
Near Police Station,Johangirpuri
Delhi-110033

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sheershak Aggarwal R/o Farm No.16, Defodil, Lane, Satbari, Chattarpur, New Delhi-110074** Also at **S-206, First Floor, Panchsheel Park, New Delhi-110017** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CT No. 2811/2020, U/s 138 NI Act at PS: Model Town, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sheershak Aggarwal** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sheershak Aggarwal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sheershak Aggarwal of CT No. 2811/2020, U/s 138 NI Act of PS: Model Town, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 09.10.2026.**
By order
Aakash Sharma
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North Court No.213,
Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/11930/NW/2026

Government of India Ministry of Jal Shakti Department of Water Resources, River Development & Ganga Rejuvenation National Mission for Clean Ganga

Vacancy Circular

National Mission for Clean Ganga invites online applications for engagement of three consultants on a contractual basis initially for a period of one year, with the following details:

Sl. No.	Designation	Consolidated Monthly Remuneration (Rs.)
1.	Consultant (Water Resources Specialist (Grade-I))	Rs 1,10,000/-
2.	Consultant (Information Technology (Grade-I))	Rs 1,10,000/-
3.	Consultant (District Ganga Planning & Coordination) (Grade-I))	Rs 1,10,000/-

Eligible and interested candidates may visit the official website of NMCG (nmcg.nic.in) for the detailed advertisement. The last date for submission of online application will be 30 days from the date of publication of this circular in the Employment News.

CBC 45125/11/0003/2627

JAPIT
Jharkhand Agency for Promotion of Information Technology
(An Autonomous body under Department of IT & e-Governance, Govt. of Jharkhand)
Ground Floor, Engineer's Hostel – I, Near Golchakkar, Dhurwa, Ranchi, Jharkhand
Phone. 0651-2401044/2401067, E-mail- japit_doit@rediffmail.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

On behalf of Government of Jharkhand, Jharkhand Agency for Promotion of Information Technology (JAP-IT) invites online bid through Jharkhand e-procurement portal (<https://Jharkhandtenders.gov.in>) for “Selection of Service Provider for Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract of IP CCTV System installed at various District Courts”.

1.	Tender Reference number	JAP-IT/CCTV/AMC/06/2026
2.	Name of Work	Selection of Service Provider for Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract of IP CCTV System installed at various District Courts
3.	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	INR 10,00,000/- (Rupees Ten Lakhs Only) through Jharkhand e-Procurement portal
4.	Start date downloading Tender document	04.09.2026
5.	Site Visit Schedule	07.09.2026 to 12.09.2026 (From 11.30 AM at 4.30 PM)
6.	Last Date for sending Pre-Bid Query	14-09-2026
7.	Pre-bid meeting	16-09-2026, 03:00 PM
8.	Start date of bid submission	26.09.2026, 03:00 PM
9.	Last date and time of Online Bid Submission	08.10.2026, 03:00 PM
10.	Technical Bid Opening	09.10.2026, 03:30 PM
11.	Commercial Bid Opening	To be informed later.
12.	Place of Pre-Bid Meeting/ Communication/ Bid Submission/ Bid Opening	JAP-IT, Ground Floor, Engineers Hostel 1, Near Golchakkar, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004
13.	Civil Courts, Chaibasa City:- Chaibasa Dist:- West Singhbhum State:- Jharkhand PIN Code:- 833201 Email:- palamajudgeship@gmail.com FAX :- 06582 256398 Civil Court Ranchi Civil Court Main Building, First Floor, Ranchi-834001 Jharkhand Email :- reg-ranchi@aij.gov.in Contact: 0651-2212423 Fax : 0651-2202414 Contact for Site Visit Civil Court, Dhanbad Email :- reg-dhanbad@aij.gov.in TEL/FAX: 0326-2311689	
14.	Contact/ Pre-Bid query e-mail ID	Tel: 0651-2401044 Email: ceo.japit@jharkhandmail.gov.in / japit_doit@rediffmail.com

Note: 1. JAP-IT reserves the right to change the conditions or cancel the tendering process at any stage without assigning any reason thereof. Please visit the portal regularly for the same.
2. The Bidders are advised to submit the Bids well in advance as JAP-IT/GoJ will not be responsible for non-submission of the bids because of any technical glitches
Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer
JAP-IT
PR 389090 Information Technology (26-27)_D

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!

IMPORTANT INFORMATION

FESTIVAL SPECIAL TRAINS-2026

During the upcoming festival season, Railways have decided to run the following Festival Special Trains as per the details given below:

Train No. 04209/04210 Varanasi - Delhi Jn. - Varanasi Reserved Festival Special Express Train 50 Trips

Train No. 04209	STATIONS	Train No. 04210		
Arr.	Dep.	Arr.	Dep.	
--	22:15	Varanasi	09:50	--
13:45	--	Delhi Jn.	--	18:50

Days of Run: 04209 Ex Varanasi on every Friday, Monday & Wednesday from 02.10.2026 to 27.11.2026 and 04210 Ex Delhi Jn. on every Saturday, Tuesday & Thursday from 03.10.2026 to 28.11.2026.
Accommodation: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Maa Belha Devi Dham, Rae Bareilly, Lucknow, Hardoi, Rampur, Moradabad, Gajraula Jn., Hapur, Ghaziabad & New Delhi Stations.

Train No. 04213/04214 Ayodhya Cantt. - Anand Vihar (T) - Ayodhya Cantt. Reserved Festival Special Express Train 36 Trips

Train No. 04213	STATIONS	Train No. 04214		
Arr.	Dep.	Arr.	Dep.	
--	18:20	Ayodhya Cantt.	22:00	--
06:10	--	Anand Vihar (T)	--	09:00

Days of Run: 04213 Ex Ayodhya Cantt. on every Thursday & Sunday from 01.10.2026 to 29.11.2026 and 04214 Ex Anand Vihar (T) on every Friday, Monday & Saturday from 02.10.2026 to 30.11.2026.
Accommodation: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Barabanki, Lucknow, Shahjehanpur, Bareilly, Moradabad, Amroha, Hapur & Ghaziabad Stations.

Train No. 04512/04511 Chandigarh - Patna Jn. - Chandigarh Reserved Festival Special Express Train (Weekly) 18 Trips

Train No. 04512	STATIONS	Train No. 04511		
Arr.	Dep.	Arr.	Dep.	
--	23:35	Chandigarh	21:40	--
21:15	--	Patna Jn.	--	23:15

Days of Run: 04512 Ex Chandigarh on every Thursday from 01.10.2026 to 26.11.2026 and 04511 Ex Patna Jn. on every Friday from 02.10.2026 to 27.11.2026.
Accommodation: 1st AC, AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Ambala Cantt., Saharanpur, Roorkee, Moradabad, Bareilly, Shahjehanpur, Hardoi, Alamnagar, Utraithia Jn., Sultanpur, Varanasi, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Jn., Buxar, Ara & Danapur Stations.

Train No. 04616/04615 Firozpur Cantt Jn. - Patna Jn. - Firozpur Cantt. Jn. Reserved Festival Special Express Train (Weekly) 16 Trips

Train No. 04616	STATIONS	Train No. 04615		
Arr.	Dep.	Arr.	Dep.	
--	12:00	Firozpur Cantt Jn.	23:55	--
18:35	--	Patna Jn.	--	20:20

Days of Run: 04616 Ex Firozpur Cantt Jn. on every Tuesday from 06.10.2026 to 24.11.2026 and 04615 Ex Patna Jn. on every Wednesday from 07.10.2026 to 25.11.2026.
Accommodation: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Moga, Ludhiana, Ambala Cant Jn., Yamunanagar Jagadhri, Saharanpur, Roorkee, Najibabad Jn., Moradabad, Bareilly, Shahjehanpur Jn., Hardoi, Balama Jn., Alam Nagar, Utraithia Jn., Rae Bareilly Jn., Maa Belha Devi Dham Pratappgarh Jn. Janghal Jn., Varanasi, PT. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Jn., Buxar, Raghunathpur, Ara & Danapur Stations.

Train No. 02456/02455 New Delhi - Kanpur Central - New Delhi Reserved Festival Special Superfast Express Train 98 Trips

Train No. 02456	STATIONS	Train No. 02455		
Arr.	Dep.	Arr.	Dep.	
--	07:45	New Delhi	20:20	--
13:15	--	Kanpur Central	--	15:00

Days of Run: 02456 Ex New Delhi & 02455 Ex Kanpur Central on every Monday, Wednesday, Friday & Saturday from 07.09.2026 to 30.11.2026.
Accommodation: AC 3 Tier & Sleeper.
Stoppages: Aligarh Jn. & Etawah Stations.

Train No. 04014/04013 Anand Vihar (T) - Laukaha Bazar - Anand Vihar (T) Reserved Festival Special Express Train 150 Trips

Train No. 04014	STATIONS	Train No. 04013		
Arr.	Dep.	Arr.	Dep.	
--	15:40	Anand Vihar (T)	03:15	--
20:15	--	Laukaha Bazar	--	21:30

Days of Run: 04014 Ex Anand Vihar (T) (Daily) from 16.09.2026 to 29.11.2026 & 04013 Ex Laukaha Bazar (Daily) from 17.09.2026 to 30.11.2026
Accommodation: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Ghaziabad, Moradabad, Bareilly, Shahjehanpur, Sitapur Jn., Gonda Jn., Gorakhpur Jn., Kaptanganj Jn., Siswa Bazar, Bagaha, Harinagar, Narkatiaganj Jn., Sikta, Raxaul Jn., Bairagnia, Sitamarhi, Shisho, Sakri Jn., Jhanjharpur Jn. & Vachaspatinagar Stations.

Train No. 04002/04001 Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn. - Dadar - Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn. Reserved Festival Special Superfast Express Train (Weekly) 14 Trips

Train No. 04002	STATIONS	Train No. 04001		
Arr.	Dep.	Arr.	Dep.	
--	23:45	H. Nizamuddin Jn.	21:35	--
22:40	--	Dadar	--	00:15

Days of Run: 04002 Ex Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn. on every Tuesday from 13.10.2026 to 24.11.2026 & 04001 Ex Dadar on every Thursday from 15.10.2026 to 26.11.2026.
Accommodation: 1st AC, AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier
Stoppages: Kosi Kalan, Mathura, Gangapur City, Kota, Ratlam, Vadodara, Surat, Vapi & Borivali Stations.

Train No. 04227/04228 Varanasi Jn. - Chandigarh - Varanasi Jn. Reserved Festival Special Express Train 36 Trips

Train No. 04227	STATIONS	Train No. 04228		
Arr.	Dep.	Arr.	Dep.	
--	11:05	Varanasi Jn.	00:55	--
04:20	--	Chandigarh	--	06:00

Days of Run: 04227 Ex Varanasi Jn. on every Thursday & Sunday from 01.10.2026 to 29.11.2026 and 04228 Ex Chandigarh on every Friday & Monday from 02.10.2026 to 30.11.2026.
Accommodation: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Maa Belha Devi Dham, Pratapgarh Jn., Rae Bareilly Jn., Lucknow, Shahjehanpur, Bareilly, Moradabad, Roorkee, Saharanpur & Ambala Cantt. Jn. Stations.

Train No. 04008/04007 Anand Vihar (T) - Jogbani - Anand Vihar (T) Reserved Festival Special Express Train (Weekly) 10 Trips

Train No. 04008	STATIONS	Train No. 04007		
Arr.	Dep.	Arr.	Dep.	
--	08:30	Anand Vihar (T)	03:00	--
15:00	--	Jogbani	--	18:30

Days of Run: 04008 Ex Anand Vihar (T) on every Saturday from 10.10.2026 to 07.11.2026 and 04007 Ex Jogbani on every Sunday from 11.10.2026 to 08.11.2026.
Accommodation: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Ghaziabad, Hapur, Garhmuktesar, Moradabad, Bareilly, Shahjehanpur, Sitapur Jn., Gonda Jn., Gorakhpur Jn., Chhapra, Sonpur, Hajipur Jn., Shahpur Patoree, Barauni Jn., Begu Sarai, Khagaria Jn., Mansi Jn., Naugachia, Katihar Jn., Purnea Jn., Araria Court & Forbesganj Jn. Stations.

Train No. 04028/04027 Anand Vihar (T) - Muzaffarpur Jn. - Anand Vihar (T) Reserved Festival Special Express Train 26 Trips

Train No. 04028	STATIONS	Train No. 04027		
Arr.	Dep.	Arr.	Dep.	
--	09:15	Anand Vihar (T)	05:30	--
04:30	--	Muzaffarpur Jn.	--	06:15

Days of Run: 04028 Ex Anand Vihar (T) on every Tuesday & Friday from 13.10.2026 to 24.11.2026 and 04027 Ex Muzaffarpur Jn. on every Wednesday & Saturday from 14.10.2026 to 25.11.2026.
Accommodation: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Amroha, Moradabad, Bareilly, Shahjehanpur, Sitapur Jn., Gonda Jn., Basti, Gorakhpur Jn., Chhapra, Sonpur Jn. & Hajipur Jn. Stations.

Train No. 04010/04009 Delhi Jn. - Sitamarhi - Delhi Jn. Reserved Festival Special Express Train (Weekly) 12 Trips

Train No. 04010	STATIONS	Train No. 04009		
Arr.	Dep.	Arr.	Dep.	
--	23:05	Delhi Jn.	20:30	--
23:30	--	Sitamarhi	--	00:45

Days of Run: 04010 Ex Delhi Jn. on every Thursday from 15.10.2026 to 19.11.2026 and 04009 Ex Sitamarhi on every Saturday from 17.10.2026 to 21.11.2026.
Accommodation: 1st AC, AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, 3 Tier Economy, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Ghaziabad, Moradabad, Bareilly, Shahjehanpur, Sitapur, Gonda Jn., Gorakhpur, Bagaha, Narkatiaganj Jn., Sikta, Raxaul Jn. & Bairagnia Stations.

Train No. 02458/02457 Anand Vihar (T) - Kanpur Central - Anand Vihar (T) Reserved Festival Special Superfast Express Train 72 Trips

Train No. 02458	STATIONS	Train No. 02457		
Arr.	Dep.	Arr.	Dep.	
--	08:20	Anand Vihar (T)	20:10	--
13:15	--	Kanpur Central	--	15:00

Days of Run: 02458 Ex Anand Vihar (T) & 02457 Ex Kanpur Central on every Tuesday, Thursday & Sunday from 08.09.2026 to 29.11.2026.
Accommodation: AC 3 Tier & Sleeper.
Stoppages: Aligarh Jn. & Etawah Stations.

Train No. 04314/04313 Yog Nagari Rishikesh - Muzaffarpur Jn. - Yog Nagari Rishikesh Reserved Festival Special Express Train (Weekly) 18 Trips

Train No. 04314	STATIONS	Train No. 04313		
Arr.	Dep.	Arr.	Dep.	
--	15:20	Yog Nagari Rishikesh	11:15	--
11:45	--	Muzaffarpur Jn.	--	13:15

Days of Run: 04314 Ex Yog Nagari Rishikesh on every Sunday from 04.10.2026 to 29.11.2026 & 04313 Ex Muzaffarpur Jn. on every Monday from 05.10.2026 to 30.11.2026.
Accommodation: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Haridwar Jn., Moradabad, Bareilly, Shahjehanpur, Sitapur, Gonda, Basti, Gorakhpur, Siwan, Chhapra, Sonpur & Hajipur Stations.

Train No. 04096/04095 Anand Vihar (T) - Patliputra - Anand Vihar (T) Reserved Festival Special Express Train 120 Trips

Train No. 04096	STATIONS	Train No. 04095		
Arr.	Dep.	Arr.	Dep.	
--	00:05	Anand Vihar (T)	21:30	--
23:00	--	Patliputra	--	00:45

Days of Run: 04096 Ex Anand Vihar (T) (Daily) from 01.10.2026 to 29.11.2026 & 04095 Ex Patliputra on (Daily) from 02.10.2026 to 30.11.2026.
Accommodation: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Ghaziabad, Kanpur Central, Prayagraj Jn., Varanasi, Ghazipur City, Phephenia, Ballia, Sahatwar, Bakulha, Chhapra Jn. & Dighwara Stations.

For any kind of information and detailed time-table etc., passengers are requested to contact RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or may visit Indian Railways website <https://enquiry.indianrail.gov.in> or NTES App.

Please join us on

NORTHERN RAILWAY
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News at a glance

Philippines Vice President Duterte posts bail after arrest

MANILA: Philippines Vice President Sara Duterte posted bail Saturday after an order was issued for her arrest the previous day on charges that she publicly threatened to arrange the assassination of President Ferdinand Marcos Jr. and two other people.

Emerging in a black outfit from Quezon City Regional Trial Court in Metro Manila, Duterte consoled her supporters, hugging a woman who was sobbing as supporters chanted “Duterte! Duterte!”

Namibia HIV program: US phases out annual support

WINDHOEK: The United States will start phasing out its financial support for Namibia’s HIV response programs, the latest among southern African countries to feel the effects of the withdrawal of foreign aid by the US administration.

The US will provide Namibia with USD 45 million for its HIV response in the 2027 fiscal year but the country would then start funding its own HIV programs, with US only providing “technical cooperation,” both countries said. The US says it has contributed more than USD 1.1 billion since 2003.

UK govt condemns masked anti-immigrant protesters

LONDON: Dozens of masked anti-immigration protesters blocked roads leading to Britain’s busiest ferry port on Saturday, clogging traffic and disrupting travellers and cargo vehicles heading for France.

The UK government condemned the action, saying it went beyond peaceful protest.

The Port of Dover said Saturday morning that all traffic in and out was “stopped due to an ongoing public order incident,” and police said they were “engaging with the protesters.”



An amputee war veteran wears a creation by designer Julya Kros during the Ukrainian Fashion Week show, in Kyiv, Ukraine

AP/PTI

Briefs

Wedding party fire kills 22

KINSHASA: At least 22 people were killed in a fire at a wedding party in Congo’s capital, Kinshasa, the regional mayor said Saturday.

Several other people were injured in the fire that started overnight Friday and continued into early Saturday morning in a building in Lingwala in northern Kinshasa.

Several people were laid by the roadside as attendees tried to help the ones who were still alive.

Pak: Minor killed in drone attack

PESHAWAR: A minor girl was killed in a quadcopter attack in Pakistan’s Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, local police said on Saturday.

According to police, security forces were conducting an intelligence-based operation targeting suspected militant hideouts in Kohat district.

In response, the militants launched a quadcopter attack targeting a densely populated area, killing a minor girl, a police official said.

Cubans and Afghans deported

GEORGETOWN: Guyana’s government said Saturday it has received the first of six deportees from the United States under the Trump administration’s third-country deportation system. Guyana’s Foreign Secretary Robert Persaud said the six nationals of Cuba and Afghanistan arrived on Friday after being vetted by his administration and found to have no criminal backgrounds.

Croatians call for cleanup of toxic waste

ZAGREB: Tens of thousands of people rallied on Saturday in Croatia, furious that authorities for months haven’t cleared a huge amount of illegally dumped hazardous waste that has triggered fears of major environmental damage in the European Union country.

The illegal waste scandal in the central town of Gospić has fuelled criticism of conservative Prime Minister Andrej Plenković and his government.

US ENVOYS STEVE WITKOFF AND JARED KUSHNER HOLD TALKS

Putin and Zelenskyy agree to pause air strikes on Kyiv and Moscow

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Moscow, September 5

Russian President Vladimir Putin ordered a 72-hour pause in strikes on Kyiv, the Kremlin said Saturday, as US envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner arrived in Moscow to try to revive a stalled push to end Russia’s full-scale invasion of Ukraine.

“Putin has ordered that no strikes be carried out against Kyiv for three days, starting at midnight today,” presidential spokesperson Dmitry Peskov told Russia’s Tass news agency. He said the decision was tied to preparations for Witkoff and Kushner’s planned visit to the Ukrainian capital, which Kyiv has said will take place on Sunday.

The envoys’ trip comes as both sides escalate aerial attacks, some 4.5-years after the Kremlin’s invasion of its neighbour. Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Friday that Ukraine would halt airstrikes during the envoys’ visit and urged Moscow to do the same.

Washington’s push to end the fighting, now in its fifth year, has lost momentum as US attention has been focused for the last six months on its war with Iran. The last known visit



Emergency services personnel work to extinguish a fire at pharmaceuticals warehouse stores following a Russian air attack near Kyiv, Ukraine

AP/PTI

KEY POINTS

- » The envoys’ trip comes as both sides escalate aerial attacks, some 4.5-years after the Kremlin’s invasion of its neighbour
- » Washington’s push to end the fighting, now in its fifth year, has lost momentum as US attention has been focused for the last six months on its war with Iran

to Moscow by Witkoff and Kushner, US President Donald Trump’s son-in-law, was in January, when they met Russian President Vladimir Putin in the Kremlin. They

have never previously visited Kyiv.

The envoys were met at the airport by Russian envoy Kirill Dmitriev, Tass reported. Dmitriev shared

photos of him meeting the US delegation as they disembarked, alongside the caption, “Welcome to Moscow Peacemakers.”

With peace efforts stalled, Russia has intensified its attacks on Kyiv and other cities with relentless bombardments recently stretching into daylight hours, taking advantage of Ukraine’s shortage of air defensive systems.

On Friday, a Russian drone hit one of the most important government

buildings in Kyiv – the headquarters of Ukraine’s Security Service, known as the SBU, which is one of the agencies involved in carrying out deep-strike operations inside Russia.

The long-range strikes by Ukraine have hit Russian military facilities, oil refineries and e-commerce hubs, seeking to undermine the Kremlin’s war effort and economy, as well as make ordinary citizens feel the consequences of the war.

Zelenskyy links Russian strikes to envoys’ visit.

The air war between Russia and Ukraine has intensified as troops have struggled to make progress along the 1,250-kilometre front line. Russia has recently been using fast-flying, jet-powered drones, and the recurring wail of air-raid sirens has become part of daily life in Kyiv.

In a social media post on Saturday, Zelenskyy said that Russia had carried out overnight strikes on Kyiv and Boryspil international airports, and linked the attack to the planned US visit.

“Clearly, these Russian strikes on the airports are a reaction to the discussions and preparations for the possibility of the US side using an aircraft to travel to Ukraine,” he said.

Nepal PM Shah to address UN session

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Kathmandu, September 5



Nepal Prime Minister Balendra Shah will visit the US later this month to address the 81st session of the UN General Assembly, where he is likely to raise the issue of climate change and seek compensation from the international community over the devastating flash floods.

The flash floods, triggered by an ice-rock avalanche near the Nepal-Tibet border on August 26, devastated towns and villages in northern and central Nepal, killing more

than 1,300, while around 4,900 remain missing.

Shah is scheduled to address the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) session in New York on September 24, according to the UN’s official speaking schedule. This would be his first foreign

trip since taking office on March 27.

Shah will lead the Nepalese delegation to the UNGA, Foreign Ministry sources said. Discussions and consultations are underway at various levels to formulate Nepal’s position for the UNGA.

The Ministry of Foreign Affairs is currently busy in preparation for the upcoming visit. The Prime Minister’s Office has held discussions with experts and scientists in Nepal and abroad on issues to be raised during Shah’s visit, according to officials. Nepal is likely to raise

the issue of climate change and campaign for compensation from the international community during Shah’s address to the UNGA.

Foreign Minister Shirsir Khanal will accompany Shah on the high-level visit.

A couple of days ago, Khanal held comprehensive discussions with representatives of diplomatic missions based in Nepal on the issue of climate justice that Nepal plans to raise on the global stage.

The government is assessing the human and material losses caused by the disaster.

Trump keeps heralding an economic boom

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Washington, September 5

President Donald Trump has spent 20 months promising that America was on the cusp of an economic boom.

But Friday’s surprisingly positive jobs report ultimately provoked frustration from Trump.

The August job numbers might have been a welcome break from after months of sluggish hiring and concerns about inflation that have been weighing on Trump and his party two months from Election Day.

But speaking from the Oval Office, Trump instead launched into a grievance session about inflation and interest rates. His anger was aimed at the financial markets, the Federal Reserve and US trade partners.

He objected to the commonly accepted notion in economics that the surprise gain of 162,000 jobs in August could contribute to inflationary pressures.

“Success does not cause inflation. Stupidity causes inflation,” Trump vented in the Oval Office, as he declared it “crazy” that the stock markets fell Friday on inflation concerns.

Nepal flood survivors join rescue and relief operations

They grieve, search for their loved ones

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Nuwakot, September 5



Even as they grieve the loss of loved ones and search for missing family members, several survivors of Nepal’s devastating floods have returned to the front lines to help others affected by the disaster.

Sudip Kumar Neupane, 31, survived the August 26 flood that swept away his younger brother and a close colleague.

After spending two days grieving, he joined the relief efforts, helping with the distribution of food and other assistance to dis-

CLOSER LOOK

- » Flash floods, triggered by an ice-rock avalanche near the Nepal-Tibet border on August 26
- » The three men were racing back towards safety after being warned that the flood was approaching

placed people in Rasuwa, The Kathmandu Post newspaper reported on Saturday.

Flash floods, triggered by an ice-rock avalanche near the

Nepal-Tibet border on August 26, devastated towns and villages in northern and central Nepal, killing more than 1,300, while around 5,000 remain missing.

Neupane had been helping warn villagers about the approaching flood when he was caught in the torrent along with his 27-year-old brother Pradip and an acquaintance, Janak.

The three men were racing back towards safety after being warned that the flood was approaching. The flood struck soon afterwards, sweeping away Pradip and Janak. Neupane survived after running uphill.

INDIA COMPLETED THE CHASE IN 8.4 OVERS

Women’s Asia Cup T20: Spinners lead India to 7-wicket win against Pakistan

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Dubai, September 5

Young spin twins Shree Charani and Prema Rawat strangled Pakistan with deadly spells as India trampled all over their arch-rivals, winning a lopsided Women’s Asia Cup T20 contest by seven wickets here on Saturday.

Harmanpreet Kaur, who became the first international captain (men or women) to lead the country in 150 T20Is, couldn’t have been more pleased to find her spinners skittling out Pakistan for 55 in just 18.1 overs – their lowest-ever total in the shortest format.

Fittingly, she finished the game with a regal six down the ground.

India’s spinners – 22-year-old left-arm orthodox Charani (3/7 in 4 overs), 24-year-old leg-break bowler Prema (3/9 in 4 overs) and part-time wrist spinner Shafali Verma (1/10 in 3 overs) completely dismantled the Pakistan batting.

Deepti Sharma (2/5 in 3.1 overs) completed the formalities.

India completed the chase in 8.4 overs despite losing Shafali Verma (12), Smriti Mandhana (9) and Pratika Rawal (4) cheaply



Indian spinner Prema Rawat celebrating with skipper Harmanpreet Kaur after taking a wicket in Women’s Asia Cup 2026

to Pakistan skipper Fatima Sana. Harmanpreet (18 n.o.) and Deepti (12 n.o.) used all their experience to calm the nerves after some initial jitters. With no scoreboard pressure, Pakistan bowlers never had any chance as such to create an upset.

Indian women would have expected a bit of practice before their semi-finals but such was the plight of Pakistani batters that once again it became a ‘No Contest’.

In the history of T20 Asia Cup, India have won seven games to Pakistan’s one.

Earlier, opting to bat, Pakistan did start confidently reaching 27 for no loss in little over four overs with openers Muneeba Ali (13) and Shawaal Zulfiqar (14) facing the seamers with ease but none of the other batters were able to reach double figures in an embarrassing display of ineptitude.

The two wrist spinners, Shafali and Prema, didn’t try to turn and kept attacking the stumps with relentless accuracy. By the time, Deepti came in to bowl, Pakistan women had already thrown

in the towel.

In 18.1 overs, Indian bowlers delivered an astounding 78 dot balls.

Once, Harmanpreet Kaur, captaining the country for the 150th time in T20Is, gauged that the pitch was offering turn, she introduced the spinners right away and got due dividends. Suddenly Pakistan lost six wickets for the addition of nine runs to totter at 36 for 6 after the end of 10 overs.

Strangled for runs, Muneeba tried to shuffle towards leg stump to make room and was beaten

KEY POINTS

- » India’s spinners — left-arm orthodox Charani (3/7 in 4 overs), leg-break bowler Prema (3/9 in 4 overs) & part-time wrist spinner Shafali Verma (1/10 in 3 overs) completely dismantled the Pakistan batting
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all ends up.

Charani then exploited the difficult pitch, extracting sharp turn and bounce. Gull Feroza (0) fell at short third while attempting to hit against the turn, before Zulfiqar was trapped plumb in front attempting a sweep. Ayesha Zafar (2) was caught at mid-on trying to break free, while Sadaf Shamas (3) was bowled by Prema.

Skipper Fatima Sana (0) was trapped in front by Deepti Sharma, and further run-outs and poor sweeps sealed Pakistan’s collapse before India batted.



PRABHDEEP WAS THE MOST PROLIFIC SCORER OF THE DAY, FINDING THE NET FIVE TIMES TO EARN THE ‘PLAYER OF THE MATCH’ AWARD

continued to find openings in the second quarter. Anmol got his first goal of the match in the 16th minute when the Indonesian defence was penalised with a penalty stroke. Yadav added another four minutes later to make it 4-0.

Prabhdeep then took centre stage, scoring in the 26th and 30th minutes to complete his hat-trick and take India into half-time with a commanding 6-0 lead.

There was little respite for Indonesia after the break, with India continuing to dominate possession and territory. Anmol was particularly effective from set-pieces, converting penalty corners in the 35th and 42nd minutes to add two more goals to his tally.

Prabhdeep then struck again shortly before the end of the third quarter, as the scoreline read 9-0.

The final quarter proved to be the most productive period of the match as India found the net five more times.

Anmol completed his four-goal haul in the 51st minute, before Prabhdeep scored again a minute later to bring up his fifth goal of the match.

Yadav then completed his hat-trick in emphatic fashion, scoring twice in the 53rd minute as India surged to a 13-0 advantage. Maurya rounded off the scoring in the 59th minute, scoring off a penalty corner to complete the 14-0 rout.

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Women’s Junior Asia Cup: India begins title defence with 4-1 win over South Korea

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Moqi (China), September 5

India began its title defence at the Women’s Junior Asia Cup with a 4-1 win over South Korea here on Saturday.

The defending champions, who have won the last two editions of the Women’s Junior Asia Cup, produced a composed and dominant performance against South Korea, with Sanika Chandrakant Mane, Purnima Yadav, Puja Sahoo and Madhu Sidar finding the back of the net.

India started the contest with intent and created

several opportunities in the opening quarter. Their efforts were rewarded in the 8th minute when Sanika opened the scoring to give India an early 1-0 lead.

The Indian side continued to put pressure on the South Korean defence and earned two penalty corners in the opening quarter, including one in the 14th minute, but were unable to convert either opportunity.

India continued their attacking approach at the start of the second quarter and won another penalty corner within the opening five minutes.

They were awarded

a re-pc after the initial attempt, but India could not find the back of the net.

South Korea responded with increased pressure and earned back-to-back penalty corners within a five-minute period as they looked for an equaliser. However, the Indian defence remained resolute and successfully kept the Korean attack at bay.

India then regained control of proceedings and earned another penalty corner in the dying moments of the second quarter. This time, the Indian side executed a well-worked variation, with

Purnima Yadav finishing the move in the 30th minute to double India’s advantage and send the team into the half-time break with a 2-0 lead.

South Korea showed renewed intent in the third quarter, but India’s defence held firm under pressure. India extended its lead to 3-0 through Puja Sahoo’s penalty-corner conversion.

Madhu Sidar then scored in the 51st minute to make it 4-0. South Korea pulled one back in the 57th minute through KIL Gabin after a penalty-corner variation, but India held on to secure a commanding win.

AGENCIES
New York, September 5

Serena and Venus Williams’ return to the US Open ended in heartbreak as the sisters squandered a 5-0 lead in the deciding match tiebreaker before losing to Hao-Ching Chan and Maya Joint 6-3, 6-7 (6), 7-6 (10-7) on Friday.

The defeat marked their first US Open appearance since 2022 at the Grand Slam they won twice. After trailing 4-1 in the third set, the Williams sisters fought back to level the match before faltering late.

Serena, 44, returned to



Venus Williams, left, and Serena Williams, of the US, look on as they play against Hao-Ching Chan, of Taiwan & Maya Joint, of Australia, during a women’s doubles match at the US Open in New York AP/PTI

tennis this year after a long layoff, while Venus, 46, has continued competing on tour. The sisters, who

have won 14 Grand Slam doubles titles and Olympic gold in 2000, 2008 and 2012, now have two heart-breaking defeats together since Serena’s comeback.

They also lost in a match tiebreaker at the Cincinnati Open.

Defending champion Carlos Alcaraz advanced to the fourth round with a 6-3, 6-4, 6-1 win over Wu Yibing.

Two-time defending champion Aryna Sabalenka beat Kamilla Rakhimova 6-3, 6-4 after being briefly distracted by the smell of marijuana during the match.

WORLD ARCHERY PARA SERIES

Harvinder, Bhawana top seeds in doubles as India make solid start

AGENCIES
Ahmedabad, September 5

Reigning Paralympic recurve open champion Harvinder Singh led India’s strong showing as eight home archers advanced to the pre-quarterfinals at the World Archery Para Series here on Saturday.

Harvinder qualified third in the men’s recurve open section with 636 points, behind Iran’s Gholamreza Rahimi (647) and

Indonesia’s Kholdin (641). Parveen finished fifth with 633, Sehajveer Singh sixth with 626 and Vijay Sundi seventh with 618. All four advanced directly to the pre-quarterfinals.

In the women’s section, Bhawana qualified third with 595 points, behind Indonesia’s Noviera Ross (603) and Iran’s Somayeh Rahimi Ghaderjani (602). Pooja Kumari, Rajshri Rathod and another Pooja finished fifth (573), eighth

(560) and ninth (527), respectively, also progressing directly. India secured top seeding in both doubles events. Harvinder and Parveen topped the men’s doubles with 1,269 points, while Bhawana and Pooja Kumari led the women’s event with 1,168. Both pairs advanced directly to the semifinals. Bhawana and Harvinder were third seeds in mixed doubles with 1,231 points and will face Iraq in the quarterfinals.

Satwik-Chirag one step away from season’s 2nd title after booking 3rd China Masters final

AGENCIES
Shenzhen, September 5

Indian men’s doubles pair Satwicksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty reached their third China Masters final after overcoming Malaysia’s Nur Mohd Azriyn Ayub and Tan Wee Kiong 21-15, 18-21, 21-11 in the semifinal on Saturday.

The world No. 5 Indians, runners-up in 2023 and 2025, recovered from a second-game lapse to beat the world No. 29 Malaysians in one hour and



five minutes. They moved a step closer to their second title of the season. The Asian Games cham-

pions, seeded fourth, will face the winner of the other semifinal between Malaysia’s Tee Kai Wun and Yap Roy King and China’s He Ji Ting and Ren Xiang Yu.

Satwik and Chirag trailed 0-5 early but responded with seven straight points to take control of the opening game. After dropping the second, they dominated the decider, leading 11-4 at the interval before sealing victory on their third match point.

Shot putter Toor targets 22m throw, wants to raise bar like Neeraj Chopra
He wants Indian shot putters to reach a stage where 20m, 21m are no longer considered exceptional distances

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Patiala, September 5

India’s most accomplished shot putter Tajinderpal Singh Toor wants to breach the long-awaited 22m barrier and set a benchmark for the next generation much like Neeraj Chopra has raised the bar for the country’s javelin throwers.

The 31-year-old national record holder, who has a personal best of 21.77m, wants Indian shot putters

to reach a stage where 20m and 21m are no longer considered exceptional distances.

“It’s my aim and dream to throw 22m and create a national record, so that the younger generation of Indian shot putters think 21m is nothing,” Toor said.

Chopra’s rise has had a similar impact on Indian javelin, with his Olympic gold and 90.23m national record pushing the benchmark higher. The likes



of Rohit Yadav (87.68m), Sachin Yadav (86.54m) and Kishore Jena (87.54m), Yashvir Singh (85.41m) have

all breached the 85m mark.

“Like Neeraj has thrown 90m, so 80m-82m is considered nothing. Rohit has thrown 87.68m, Sachin has thrown 86m-plus and Yashvir did a personal best at CWG. If we see, India has some of the most javelin throwers in the world who have thrown above 85m,” Toor said.

However, Toor feels injuries have repeatedly prevented him from performing to his full potential.

“Injuries have always been there with me. A lot of people say he doesn’t perform outside (India). But when the person is not fit, how will he perform? From the very first day, injuries have been there with me,” he said.

In fact, Toor competed at the recent Commonwealth Games in Glasgow with a Grade 1 calf muscle tear sustained just 12 days before the event.

“12 days before the

CWG, I sustained a Grade 1 tear in the calf. Because of that I was not able to perform well.

“I had to stop my throw and stop all the activities that require the calf. But I managed 20m despite windy conditions there,” he said.

Toor finished fifth at the CWG with a best throw of 20.27m, missing out on a medal despite believing the podium was within his reach.

Liverpool loses another top executive as sporting director steps down

ASSOCIATED PRESS
London, September 5

Richard Hughes has stepped down from his role as Liverpool sporting director, becoming the latest high-ranking executive to depart the Premier League club recent months.

Hughes, who is reportedly set to join Saudi Arabian club Al-Hilal, is leaving less than two months after Michael Edwards exited as CEO of football for Liverpool owner Fenway Sports Group. Liverpool said Saturday that Hughes wanted to “seek a fresh challenge.”

Hughes had joined the club in 2024 & oversaw the appointment of head coach Arne Slot after manager Jurgen Klopp stepped down.

Liverpool went on to win the Premier League title the following season but endured a disappointing campaign last term despite spending around \$500 million on new signings.

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REFUSES TO DIE

Diesel is Back, And India Isn't Apologizing

Years after being declared dead, diesel is clawing back its marketshare, helped by SUV demand, running costs, E20 anxiety and motorists rediscovering torque

AUTHOR



RAJEEV NARAYAN

For years, diesel has been treated in India like a troublesome relative: useful, occasionally impressive, but best kept at arm's length. Petrol has been deemed cleaner, quieter and politically safer. But of late have come torquey SUVs, escalating fuel bills, the E20 fiasco and many motorists discovering that old relationships can actually be rekindled.

The numbers are making the point more eloquently than any auto columnist can. Diesel accounted for 17.73 per cent of passenger-vehicle retail sales in July 2026, up sharply from 16.32 per cent in June. And revealingly, diesel sales in the first half of 2026 were up 15 per cent year-on-year, to 4.56 lakh units. Its share in FY 2026-27 has already climbed to 19.39 per cent, against 18.08 per cent in FY 2025-26. No, diesel is not staging a coup. It is just refusing to die.

Petrol Problem

There is an elephant at every fuel station, one wearing an E20 jumpsuit. India's nationwide move to force-use petrol containing up to 20 per cent ethanol was driven by respectable objectives—reducing crude-oil imports, saving foreign exchange and cutting emissions. The trouble began when motorists compared the policy brochure with what their cars were doing.

Owners of older petrol vehicles reported poorer mileage, rough running, hard starts and increased maintenance. A July LocalCircles survey found that nearly six in 10 owners of pre-2023 petrol cars reported a mileage drop of more than 10 per cent; while 45 per cent reported unusual wear or higher repair requirements. Workshops have also reported clogged injectors and fuel-system complaints.

The government and oil companies, however, maintain that E20 is safe for compatible vehicles and meets quality standards.

That distinction matters. It

would be reckless to declare that E20 is destroying engines en masse when the evidence does not support such a sweeping conclusion. But it would be equally foolish to pretend motorists have imagined every complaint. When a customer believes his petrol-run car has become thirstier, rougher and more expensive to maintain, he is unlikely to compose a grateful letter to the Ministry of Petroleum. He looks at the other side of the showroom.

SUV Imbroglio

The other side happens to be full of SUVs. India has spent the past decade falling obsessively in love with high-riding vehicles. What began as a part-time indulgence has turned into mass-market frenzy. Today, most of the successful diesel vehicles, overwhelmingly, are SUVs and utility vehicles.

The H1 sales list paints the picture. Mahindra's Scorpio range sold over 86,000 diesel units; Boleros crossed 58,000; XUV 7XOs did more than 42,000. Thar Roxx, Thar and Kia Seltos also posted strong numbers. Six of the ten best-selling diesel models recorded double-digit year-on-year growth.

This is not nostalgia for the

INDIA SPENT YEARS PUSHING DIESELS TOWARDS EXTINCTION. NOW, BUYERS ARE QUIETLY FANNING IT BACK TO LIFE, ONE OFFROAD JOURNEY AND FUEL BILL AT A TIME

clatter of an old-school diesel. Modern diesels are vastly more refined and produce the low-end torque that suits heavy SUVs, loaded vehicles, steep roads, long highway runs and, occasionally, the Indian conviction that a muddy track is merely an unpaved invitation. Petrol engines can be wonderfully quick. Diesels remain wonderfully muscular.

Money Talks

Then there is the classic Indian automotive argument: Kitna deti hai. Diesel cars usually cost more to buy and their emissions-control hardware can make them more expensive to maintain. For a low-



mileage urban user, petrol, CNG, hybrid or electric power can make considerably more sense. But India is not one market. A taxi operator, a highway commuter, a family doing 25,000 km a year or someone hauling seven people and luggage has a different spreadsheet.

Diesel's superior fuel economy becomes more meaningful as annual mileage rises. As does its ability to pull a large vehicle without being worked too hard. With SUVs now accounting for a huge share of new-car demand, the diesel powertrain has found a natural habitat.

There is another irony. For years, manufacturers were encouraged—through emissions rules, taxes and consumer preference—to move away from diesel. Many responded by just killing diesel engines in hatchbacks and sedans. Now, when buyers return to diesel, the menu is considerably shorter. But that scarcity has not killed demand; it has only concentrated it.

Delhi-NCR Lesson

Delhi-NCR adds a layer of absurdity to the story. The 10-year limit on diesel vehicles and 15-year limit on petrol vehicles was forced as an air-pollution measure, with the Hon'ble Supreme Court upholding the restrictions. The policy was intended to push consumers towards cleaner mobility. But it taught an entire

generation of buyers to regard diesels as a depreciating asset with a timed-bomb attached. Buy one and enjoy it. But remember that the countdown is on.

Outside NCR, however, the calculus is different. A diesel vehicle can be driven pretty much for ever and its resale value is not shaped by any timed guillotine. Buyers, thus, look at a diesel SUV and see a durable workhorse, rather than a future scrap-yard resident. That difference is important more so as the second-hand market matures and consumers become more sensitive to total ownership costs.

The Comeback

So, is diesel really back? Yes. But not in the way it once was. The age of the diesel hatchback is over. The diesel sedan is a shrinking tribe. What is returning is diesel as a specialist: the powertrain for people who want an SUV, drive distances, carry loads, dislike frequent fuel stops and would rather have torque than a brochure full of promises.

E20 may have accelerated the reincarnation, but it did not create it. The SUV boom, fuel economy, high running costs and the availability of kissable diesel engines were already doing the groundwork.

The bigger lesson is delicious. India spent years telling diesel it was yesterday's technology. Buyers listened. Then the economics changed, the SUVs got bigger, fuel became more expensive and E20 gave petrol a migraine. Suddenly, yesterday's diesel looked rather attractive again. Diesel, it turns out, wasn't dead. It was merely waiting for someone to say: "Fill it up."

Planetary Balance

PART II

Oceans in a changing climate



Melting ice and warming seas are altering ocean circulation, with consequences far beyond coastlines

AUTHOR



KRISHNA GUPTA

In Part I of the article, we covered the major ocean current systems as well as the warm and cold currents in the three largest oceans and Antarctica. In this article, we will examine how climate change is interfering with the natural rhythms of the oceans and how this is impacting rainfall, wind speeds, temperatures, marine ecosystems and agriculture around the world.

Climate Change and Ocean Currents

Climate change has disrupted the manner in which ocean currents carry heat/cold and nutrients from one part of the world to another through the 'Global Conveyor Belt'. This has happened through the warming of ocean waters and the melting of glaciers, such as those in Greenland, which has led to a lower density of ocean water. This has disrupted the 'thermohaline' circulation discussed in the first article. Further, lower salinity means acidification of the oceans, compounded by ocean water absorbing excess carbon dioxide from the air (this forms carbonic acid and makes the ocean acidic). Let us discuss the more specific aspects:

1. Freshwater from melting ice sheets in Greenland is weakening the AMOC, causing shifts in temperature, rainfall patterns, wind speeds, marine ecosystems and agricultural practices. Higher temperatures are also warming the oceans and slowing the sinking of cold water, thus weakening the AMOC. In short, the following climate impacts are likely:
 - A colder Europe and North Atlantic and warmer tropics (in particular, Africa and South Asia).
 - Interference in global monsoon systems, leading to weakened monsoons in West Africa and South Asia, including India.
 - Warmer tropics also lead to more intense hurricanes.
 - A slower AMOC means slower circulation and a lower capacity of the oceans to sequester carbon dioxide.
 - A slowing AMOC leads to lower upwelling of nutrients, putting marine ecosystems, including fisheries, under stress.
 - If continued emissions accelerate global warming and ocean warming, a tipping point could be reached where the AMOC collapses, leading to unprecedented climate impacts around the world.
2. Warming oceans could intensify the ENSO

system and lead to stronger El Niño and La Niña currents. A stronger ENSO will result from enhanced feedback loops between ocean surface temperatures and atmospheric winds in the Pacific Ocean (also called the Bjerknes effect). A more intense El Niño would mean greater-than-usual warming of Pacific waters and weaker trade winds, while a stronger La Niña would mean colder Pacific waters and more intense trade winds. Thus, a stronger El Niño would lead to more extreme cyclones and heavy rainfall in South and North America, but droughts and reduced monsoons in India, Indonesia and Australia. A stronger La Niña would produce the opposite effects: droughts and colder-than-usual winters in South and North America and flooding in Asia and Australia. These changes would put agriculture, soil conditions, food security and human health under stress.

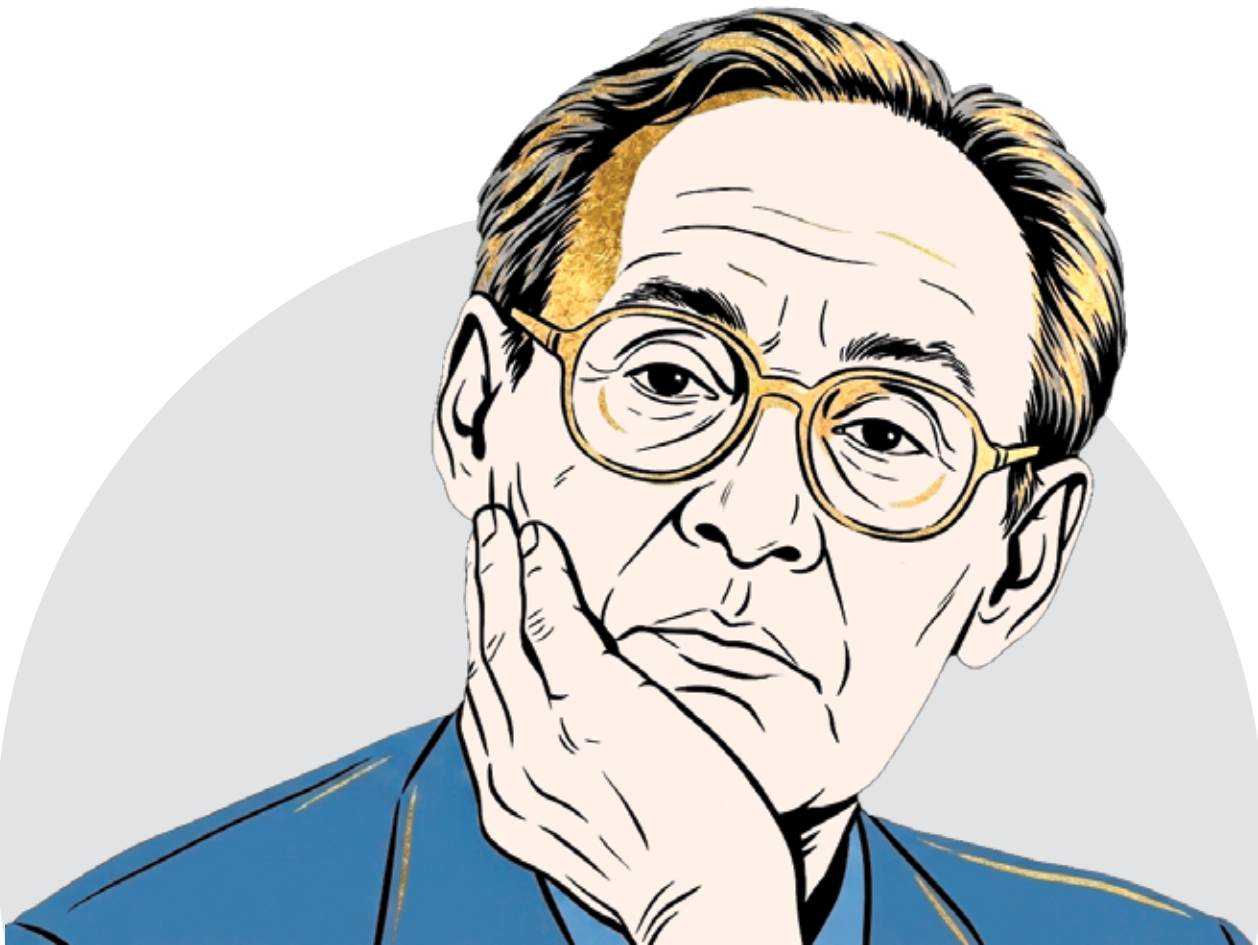
3. Climate change threatens to warm the Antarctic and lead to a loss of its vast ice sheets, releasing huge quantities of freshwater into the ocean. This reduces ocean salinity and density, creating a lighter surface layer and preventing upwelling from the deep oceans. It also alters wind patterns over the ocean. These factors threaten to disrupt the Antarctic Circumpolar Current, which, in turn, reduces the ocean's capacity to absorb carbon dioxide, leading to further warming and setting up a vicious feedback loop.

CHANGING CURRENTS CARRY PROFOUND IMPLICATIONS FOR GLOBAL FOOD SECURITY

4. Climate change is also causing disruptive changes to important warm and cold ocean currents. The normal patterns of the Gulf Stream, Kuroshio, Labrador, Agulhas and Humboldt currents are being affected by ocean warming, ice melt from Greenland and the poles, altered winds and changing surface currents, as well as the weakening of nutrient upwelling.

Conclusion

Climate change is disrupting ocean current systems as well as warm and cold ocean currents. This is adversely impacting marine ecosystems and agricultural productivity through erratic rainfall patterns and unseasonal droughts. Agriculture is also affected by increased soil erosion caused by excessive and heavy rainfall and changes in crop-growing seasons, with implications for food security. This also has implications for flood-protection works in coastal areas and the maintenance of shipping lanes for world trade.



A Historian as a Dissident-Activist

From the Emergency and Nandigram to Ayodhya and Hindutva, Sumit Sarkar’s intellectual journey was marked by an unwillingness to spare any political establishment from scrutiny

AUTHOR



SUBHORANJAN DASGUPTA

After such knowledge, what forgiveness? Think now History has many cunning passages, contrived corridors And issues, deceives with whispering ambitions, Guides us by vanities T.S. Eliot (Gerontion, 1920)

The massacre in Nandigram occurred on March 14, 2004. I went to Delhi ten days later to attend a seminar. It was decided that Tanika Sarkar, herself a brilliant historian and my very close friend, her husband—the legendary Sumit Sarkar—and I would spend an evening together at the IIC. I went to the prestigious club and, expectedly, our spontaneous conversation began.

After about ten minutes, Tanika suddenly said, “Both Sumit and I are feeling so reassured. You are a professor at a research institute totally funded by the CPI(M)-led Left Front, and we apprehended that your professional compulsion might prompt you to remain silent on the carnage. And, you know, our position.” Their stand was as clear as daylight in summer: “Jallianwala massacre happened in colonial India, but what happened in Nandigram is shocking since it happened under a Left-ruled government in independent India.”

One, my mentor, and the other, my college-mate, were ‘nervous’, as they had said. Without donning the agitator’s cap, I replied, “On the very next day, Ashok-da (revered Professor Ashok Sen), Koushik (Koushik Sen, excellent thespian), I and many others took to the streets.” These words were enough. Thereafter, we conversed with fervour for two more hours, and they met the bill. Before we parted, Sumit Sarkar, wedded to the enlightened Marxian weltanschauung like E.P. Thompson, said, “We are shattered. All this has happened and there is not a word of shame or apology from the

CPI(M) Central Committee.” Deeply aggrieved, Sumit-da returned the prestigious Rabindra Puraskar (Award) conferred on him by the Left Front Government in protest.

On another occasion, they were in Kolkata and we were invited to dinner by an erudite historian and dedicated Trotskyite. Of course, we chatted on the subject of the derogatory practices of the Communist governments in Eastern Europe. We were told that this desiccating process was initiated by Josef Stalin. At one stage, lowering his voice, Sumit-da told me in a whisper, “Trotsky, hailed by Isaac Deutscher as the *Prophet*, would have turned into another autocrat had he assumed power.” This dark observation confirmed that Sumit Sarkar did not care for any ‘sacred cow’, no matter to which camp or shed he belonged, officially Communist or not. He was a critical dissident from head to foot.

I was abroad when the Emergency was imposed. One of my friends, a young, astute historian, wrote to me: “Among the critics who do not belong to Jayaprakash Narayan’s camp, two who deserve particular mention are Romila Thapar and our teacher Sumit Sarkar.” As to how the powers-that-be harassed Romila Thapar, we know from her remarkable memoir *Just Being*. And Sumit Sarkar himself articulated a critique that was unerringly prophetic. He warned, “This draconian measure is fanning the sails of those who care a tuppence for democracy. They are exploiting the situation to wave their pseudo-democratic flags. If we give them legitimacy, we shall have to pay dearly in the future.” Need I dissect this prediction, impregnated with enviable foresight? I need to add that the CPI, which kept silent during this phase to follow the dictate of its Big Brother, Moscow, which supported the Emergency, did not cherish the acerbic evaluation of Sumit Sarkar, whom they considered to be ‘near’ and ‘dear’. The fact is, a dissident always remains lonely; he has no ‘near’ or ‘dear’.

The trenchant criticism of the Congress did not end with his denunciation of the Emergency. He said, “It must not be forgotten that it was the Congress government that updated the Ramayana epic into a pseudo-nationalist TV serial, and allowed access in

1986 to the idols installed inside the Babri Masjid by stealth and administrative collusion in December 1949, under an earlier Congress regime.” But even more disastrous was the culpability of Prime Minister Narasimha Rao before and after the fateful December 6. Sumit-da described it as ‘suicidal wobbling’, even from the point of view of narrow party interests. He emphasised, “It was yet another futile attempt to compete with the BJP for the ‘Hindu card.’ Principles apart, elementary realpolitik suggests that the more determined and consistent always win that kind of game.”

Obviously, he opposed the fantastic view of many diehard Communists that the upheaval in Soviet Russia and Eastern Europe was the result of Gorbachev’s ‘wickedness’ and ‘imperialist’ Western funding only. Everything otherwise, according to them, was hunkydory in their Communist empire! Sumit-da’s view was totally different. According to him, the entire system was a victim of deep-seated structural deficiencies. The system simply failed and collapsed, and

FOR SARKAR, INTELLECTUAL INDEPENDENCE MEANT QUESTIONING POLITICAL FORMATIONS EVEN WHEN CRITICISM CAME AT A PERSONAL OR IDEOLOGICAL COST

one of the main reasons was its intractable bureaucratic command and control. In other words, it was not possible for a single ‘villain’ (Gorbachev) to wreck an empire in seven days, extending from Vladivostok in the East to Berlin in the West. The rot had been percolating for long. His message was salutary—the complex processes of history should not be simplified in such an elementary manner.

The most sustained and flawless critique, however, was reserved for those who propagated the Hindutva version of history and BJP governance. We need to recall that it was Sumit-da, along with Tanika and two other young historians, who took on the

mythifiers masquerading as historians way back in 1993 with their stunningly new monograph *Khaki Shorts and Saffron Flags: A Critique of the Hindu Right*. Once again, Romila Thapar extended her hand of cooperation by functioning as a member of the Editorial Board, which supervised the publication of this text and others under the series *Tracts for the Times*.

Indeed, since that year, the Sarkar couple presented one text after another on this subject, epistemic as well as accusatory. The very last, *The Fascism of the Sangh Parivar* (2016), by Sumit Sarkar, acts as the culminating verdict. He certainly had his epistemic anchor—call it Marxian, if you like—but he rejected the narrow and sectarian quagmire of Hindutva history. Like Amartya Sen, Sumit Sarkar aspired to a combative heterodoxy where a hundred flowers, that is, perceptions, bloomed. He appealed for many histories and then added in his dialogue, “The human being will be at the very centre of this flowering.” And this human being, redemptive in essence, is not the blind karsevak given to vandalism. Underlining the grievous vacuity of Hindutva theory and practice, he said, “They are trying to make out of Ram and Ayodhya—a single supreme deity and pilgrimage centre, steam-rolling out of existence differences of region, sect, caste, gender, class.... An ocean separates the Ram of Mahatma Gandhi, conceived of as both Iswara and Allah, from the Ram in whose name the Babri Masjid has been destroyed.” A denunciation could not be more meaningful and emphatic.

In a sentence, Sumit-da did not articulate his vehement critique of the Congress, CPI(M), CPI and, above all, the BJP from the cosy corner of his library only. After the rampage in Ayodhya and in other moments of crisis, like the Nandigram carnage, he came out onto the streets like any other activist, alongside many protesters and students, with placards held high in his hands. He chose to demonstrate like a resolute citizen tormented by the oppressive powers-that-be. His students and colleagues admired the spirit of resistance of this frail, small-built academic who always bound himself to the defiance of the common people.

Of Sons and Soil

Through *Rising Sons*, Kavery Nambisan explores how character and circumstance shape lives across turbulent generations

AUTHOR



YAUVANIKA CHOPRA

“At times, we observe a change in a person when, in actual fact, it is the situation that has changed. At other times, we fail to see the transformation, perceiving instead that the varied situation makes it appear so.” Our narrator in *Rising Sons* – an omniscient, non-bodied voice carrying the keen intelligence and wry sensibility of Kavery Nambisan – knows the universal complexities of person and situation. This narrative voice occasionally addresses the reader directly, bringing us into the story as characters produced by similar contexts of a country changing over a century.

Mud is life for the fifty-seven families in the village of Kesarugattu, and the rain-fed rivers sustain it. “We romanced the outside world through the newspaper. Knowledge burnished our rustic minds,” informs the narrative voice. The words of Tarabai’s letter on the plight of women resonate with Gowru, a young Brahmin wife, but we move forward a couple of decades to her titular sons. The eldest, Nanju, dreams of greatness and imagines himself in the guise of Vivekananda, Aurobindo and Tilak, “but never as Gandhi”. The younger, Anna, speaks at a Congress rally in Mysoor about his gradual understanding of colonial rule and the swelling opposition to it.

Chinni, born to Gowru’s childhood friend Bhagya and her Malayali husband Dharma, understands early that the world is tilted because people hide their real selves. She writes a two-page letter to Bhagat Singh in prison expressing admiration and displeasure at the way the shooting had been carried out, even offering to marry him in prison and continue the unfinished work. She also has reservations about Gandhi and the ideals of sacrifice he advocated. But enough about Chinni – we must get back to the sons now.

There are many other fishes in the pond of Kesarugattu, and in the rivers which bring them there: Ai tribals, Brahmins, Chandals and Mussalmans. Shantadevi, Muduki, Uzman and Maimoona, Sumana, Hanumantha, Gagana, Vaidehi... even when we visit these others only briefly, their essential contours reveal themselves clearly through a narrative voice that gives minor characters the dignity of keen attention.

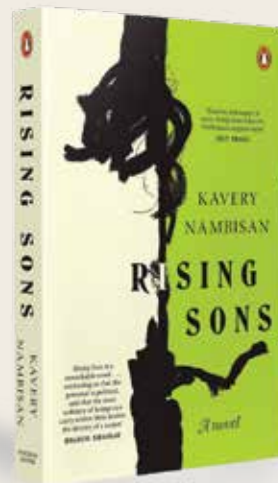
There is also another protagonist who may be listed last but could hardly be considered least: Kuppu the dog, appearing at different times as pup, adolescent and aged, peace-loving fellow. “Which is why people say, Kuppu is forever.”

The eternal archetypes which these transient human and non-human characters embody are depicted with such tenderness that even if the book were re-titled *Ondu Kaththeya Atma Kathe* or ‘Memoirs of a Donkey’, as one protagonist suggests grimly, it

could still retain the affection and insightful censure that characterise *Rising Sons*.

Donkeys do not seem to have caste pride or prejudice, however, which are among the main themes of this book. Character decides destiny because it shapes our choices, but a bruised ego leads to reaction rather than choice – the spirals that emerge from wanting to be seen in certain ways can extend to dangerous shadows. Nambisan is an observer of individual tendency as much as of the social structures of family, village and politics which shape new citizens of a new country, and which have shaped us.

Humans have a deep desire to ease each other’s pain, and a difficulty in balancing that against the restoration of their own selves. In India, virtues of Brahmin non-covetousness and Gandhian restraint were unable to stem the blood-dimmed tide of greed and vanity, which too are fundamental human vices. This slow percolation of a self-serving culture in the



CASTE PRIDE AND PREJUDICE EMERGE AS THE BOOK’S CENTRAL CONCERNS

outward guise of piety pushes the Ai people – rooted to the earth and all her creatures – into wearing “half-pants” and “proper saris” instead of the simple lengths of cloth traditionally wrapped around their bodies. There is also the implicit bleakness of rural India becoming urban in the strange erosions and sediments which have metamorphosed Bengloor into Bangalore. Much is found, much is lost. Yet this pace of change, almost tragic when viewed as a generational saga, is delivered through an authorial voice so deft and irreverent that this reader found herself smiling often, and on more than one page even laughing out loud.

Rising Sons is a story on fertile ground and rich soil, with much to recognize in the moments it portrays, as a missive which illumines the heart. It weaves its chapters through leisurely visits to the interior lives of its characters and their contexts in a manner which justifies the Irawati Karve quote with which the book begins: “Human toil, expectations, hates, friendships—all seem puny and without substance, like withered leaves eddying in the summer wind. But the people who toiled and dreamed and loved seem unforgettable...”

Greatness too Retires

AUTHOR



S KANNAN

Messi has walked away, Djokovic continues to defy retirement and Neeraj Chopra battles injury as three champions confront sport's most unforgiving opponent – time

It has been a roller-coaster, emotional ride for sports fans across the globe in many ways over the last week. News of GOAT - Greatest Of All Time - Lionel Messi walking away from international football has saddened millions. At the same time, to witness the biggest tennis star, Novak Djokovic, throw up, belch and lose in the first round of the US Open in New York is a reminder that there are no guarantees in sports.

For those who have followed the voyage of Messi, when he burst onto the international scene over two decades back for Argentina, he was almost unknown. If there were folks who said he would go on to become even greater than Diego Maradona, it's a hoax. Despite all his weaknesses, mostly by way of behaviour and being a brilliant footballer lacking discipline, Maradona was loved. That is, if you ignore the British media.

Messi was entering the turf for Argentina carrying loads of expectation from a nation where football is a passion and a religion. The big difference was that Messi, short at five feet and seven inches, had already proved his potential in club football in Europe. The world of football is an intense one where there is no dearth of riches for the players. That, perhaps, explains the kind of lavish lifestyle CR7 - Cristiano Ronaldo - is able to flaunt. Far away from Portugal, where he is hailed as King, even past his prime, Ronaldo is respected.

There have been many notable football stars in a relatively poorer European nation. For Ronaldo to live up to the hype and be seen as a star who can serve as a role model is important. For those who like to hype Messi versus Ronaldo, it was a no-brainer. So, when Messi arrived and showed how good he was at football in Europe, the world took notice.

Messi's giant shadow

Having successfully established himself in European club football, Messi then had to go about the task of delivering for Argentina. In a sport like football, to excel in club football, be it in Spain, England, Italy or Argentina alone, is not enough. How the star fires for his nation in the FIFA World Cup is more important. Messi took on the pressure, almost absorbing it like a sponge, and stepped onto the turf as an Argentine role model. He was constantly being compared, with people wondering if he could become as big as Maradona. Truth to tell, as Messi walked into the sunset, there is little doubt that he leaves Maradona behind in the shade.

What is it about Messi that people love? At five feet and seven inches, he was seen as short. In football, there is no need to be tall, broad and use only muscle to show stage presence. Messi was sneaking through rival defences so easily that he had become the toast of Argentina. Each World Cup campaign for him was getting harder, so much so that, till he had delivered the biggest trophy, there was unrest.

The ultimate triumph

How Messi and his boys pulled off that FIFA World Cup win in 2022 in Doha was magical. It was one

of the biggest showpiece events, even as doubts persisted over the capability of a desert nation where heat and many more conditions were challenging. People have said Doha is not Europe or South America. Never mind, for Messi, it was and is a brilliant hunting ground. It can never be forgotten from public memory.

The final farewell

In the 2026 edition of the FIFA World Cup, yes, the hype was on Argentina. Messi was again the cynosure, even as he was battling emotions which many did not know of. Leo Messi was physically ready for Argentina, despite being 39, but his father, Jorge, being unwell was hurting the champion. News broke that Messi was not 100 per cent 'into' the World Cup. That was false. Messi showed his best before Spain ran away with the trophy this time in the United States of America. Some football writers were ready to write his last chapter in international football.

Messi put it on hold. Why? The emotions are massive after a hard World Cup campaign. In a sport where fitness means so much and where it is so hard to be in peak shape, Messi was still kicking so beautifully. Left foot and right foot, the ball was at his mercy. Alas, he did not fire up Argentina in the finale, and Spain rose as champions.

Messi took time to realise that even this campaign was a massive load on his frame. And now, with his father departing, Messi was battling so many more emotions. His retirement post read like poetry minus the gloss. Messi bade farewell, leaving fans stunned. Another World Cup is four years away. There will be a major football showpiece event again in the form of the Summer Olympics in 2028 in Los Angeles. Messi won't be there, and let that sink in.

For those who view sport as passion, emotions and how a few moments in the field of play can bring joy, Messi will be missed. Agreed, Messi will play in Europe, but that will never be the same. Thanks, Leo, you were the maestro.

Novak feels the heat

In New York, the heat has been killing. It's hard to play high-level tennis there at this time of the year. On the heat index, it's not as dry as Melbourne in January during the Australian Open. Yet, the humidity is choking in New York, on the eastern side of the USA. Novak Djokovic has played for over two decades in New York. This time, there were doubts. For some reason, he is no longer able to handle the heat. Even in a warm-up event before the US Open, Novak had to pull out after puking.

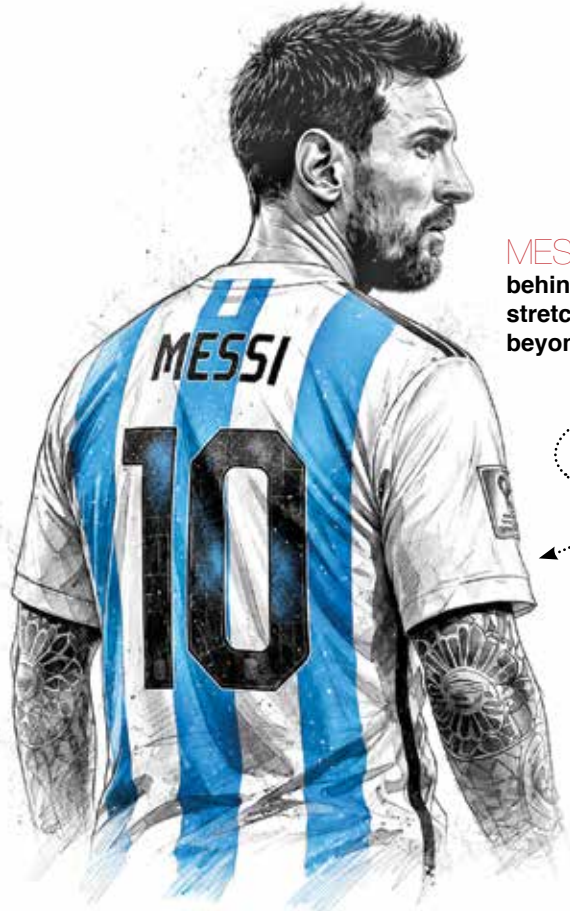
As much as fans blame age and how it is catching up with the Serbian star, the truth is different. He has a diet plan which has worked well for him till now. Novak's hydration methods are well-known. So, if he is throwing up courtside and even ice towels and cold compression do not work, it is sad. For a headline writer, 'Novak can't take the heat' may be a good one-liner.

Just like Messi, Novak did not respond immediately after losing in New York. The 39-year-old champion, who owns 24 Grand Slam singles titles and many more records, including the gold medal from the Paris 2024 Olympics, will still be in the fray. He has not mentioned retirement. On the contrary, Novak is enjoying tennis as a family sport where his wife Jelena and his kids are around him. They mean the world to him as he deals with the highs and lows. As for retirement, never try and pose

DJOKOVIC fights heat, age and time in relentless pursuit



MESSI leaves behind a legacy stretching far beyond trophies



FROM 47 SECONDS TO 21 YEARS

Lionel Messi's Argentina story almost ended before it began. Making his senior debut against Hungary in 2005, the 18-year-old lasted barely a minute before being sent off. 21 years later, the numbers are staggering: 927 goals in 1,170 senior appearances for club and country. In between came six World Cups, three World Cup finals, two Copa América titles and the trophy that transformed his international story: the 2022 World Cup. Perhaps the greatest twist is that Messi had already retired once, after the heartbreak of the 2016 Copa América final. He returned. Argentina should be grateful he changed his mind.

that question to Novak Djokovic. He is not going to give you an answer in clear words. Deep down, Nole wants to play in Los Angeles, at the Summer Olympics, one more time. As it is, Novak has cut hard on his tournament schedule. For a man who said so much in a documentary on why he avoided the Covid vaccine jabs and talked of being very healthy, dealing with heat will be on his agenda. He will not tell you and me about it, for he knows his body best. Modern science and sports medicine are there for Novak to fall back upon. If he can push his career, why not? The final choice is his, as a professional athlete.

Talk of fitness and dealing with the challenges, even Indian star Neeraj Chopra has again cut short his 2026 calendar. The latest injury to his ankle ligament is cause for worry. It's a part of the body where maximum force is exerted. Before this, Neeraj's 'back' had become a major concern. Hopefully, we will see Neeraj prepare again for an assault on one more Olympic campaign in 2028. Two Olympic medals are prized possessions in his drawing room cabinet!

SNAPSHOT

BARCELONA
672 GOALS | 778 APPEARANCES

PARIS
SAINT-GERMAIN
32 GOALS | 75 APPEARANCES

INTER MIAMI
98 GOALS | 110 APPEARANCES

ARGENTINA
125 GOALS | 207 APPEARANCES



NEERAJ faces another fitness battle on road to Los Angeles

EVEN THE GREATEST CHAMPIONS EVENTUALLY CONFRONT AGE, INJURY AND THE DIFFICULT QUESTION OF WHEN TO STOP

Meghna Gulzar wanted to explore the differing reactions within the police, law and public when it comes to crime against women

‘Knew Daayra’s story will always be relevant’

KOMAL PANCHAMATIA

Filmmaker Meghna Gulzar said she was first approached to make ‘Daayra’ in 2020 and while she had already decided to move ahead with ‘Sam Bahadur’, she knew that the story will always be relevant.

Known for films such as ‘Raazi’ and ‘Chhapaak’, the filmmaker said she wanted to explore the differing reactions within police, law and public when it comes to crime against women.

“‘Daayra’ was actually sent my way by ‘Junglee Pictures’ back in 2020, during the lockdown. It was a story whose intention grabbed me, like, what was it trying to say and why was it so important to say it? At that time, I knew that I was going to be making ‘Sam Bahadur’ next, which I did. But we also knew, all of us, that even four years later, when I start making ‘Daayra’, it’s still going to be relevant, unfortunately,” Meghna told PTI in an interview.

Written by Meghna, Yash Keswani and Sima Agarwal, the story unfolds in the aftermath of a crime that grips the nation, sparking widespread outrage while setting a series of events and two investigations in motion. As the search for answers deepens, two senior police officers, played by Kareena Kapoor Khan and Prithviraj Sukumaran, navigate the same system through different



‘WHAT ‘DAAYRA’ TRIES TO DO IS EXPLORE THE GREYS BECAUSE EVERYTHING ISN’T BLACK AND WHITE,’ SAYS THE FILMMAKER

approaches to duty and justice, on opposing sides of a case that challenges the very idea of right and wrong, reads the official synopsis of the movie.

“What ‘Daayra’ tries to do is explore the greys because everything is not black and white. What may be justice for you may be injustice for me; it depends on which side of the line we are standing on,” she added.

The film, in that sense, leans closer to the procedural tone of her 2015 investigative drama ‘Talvar’, which was loosely based on the 2008 Noida double murder case of a teenage girl and the family servant.

Asked what it about institutions is that keeps drawing her as a filmmaker, be it military in ‘Sam Bahadur’, criminal justice in ‘Talvar’ and intelligence agency in ‘Raazi’, the director said it’s always the story rather than a particular world or people that draw her in. “If the emotion in that story hooks me, it’s an instant and completely instinctive choice to tell that story. It just happens that it involves people in uniform or it involves being true life or period. That was never intended. It’s more coincidence than conscious planning.”

It was initially reported that ‘Daayra’ is inspired by the 2019 Hyderabad rape case, but Meghna said the film is an amalgamation of several real cases from across the country.

“‘Daayra’ isn’t based in a particular city, which is from South India or North India; it’s completely region-neutral. The characters are region neutral, because this is not the success or the failure of a particular

police force of a particular state,” Meghna said.

She, however, admitted that adapting real incidents into fiction isn’t easy and requires a careful balance between cinematic storytelling and a sense of responsibility. “The cinematic liberty that we have taken is maybe a bit from here, a bit from there. But we’ve never ever ‘tadkaed’ (spiced it up) it or fictionalised it to a creative liberty extent. For example, my criminal’s motivation could be the motivation of criminals from three different cases and not just one. My public reaction or the reaction of law enforcement could be from two different cases and not just one.

But is it fictional? Did I create that reaction? No, that’s the difference.”

Which is why the research and writing for ‘Daayra’ took around two years, she said. “A lot of cases that we’ve come across and are still coming across as we keep collecting and we keep reading are gut-wrenching, not just shocking,” the director said.

The region-neutral nature of the story made it essential to bring together talent from different film industries. Hence, Kareena, a top Hindi movie star and Malayalam star Prithviraj were roped in for ‘Daayra’.

The two actors brought their own interpretations to the characters and elevated them beyond what was written in the script. “They are both spontaneous and instinctive. With Prithviraj, he also looks at it; he will tell the other actor, ‘You were standing here in the previous shot and your right hand was up’, because he’s also a director. So, he will remember somebody else’s continuity as well. Kareena will also do that, but it’ll be more on an emotional level rather than a technical level. But otherwise, they’re both instinctive and definitely not method-driven.”

Asked whether she has ever dealt with the film’s central concern about boundaries imposed on women, Meghna said she personally hasn’t experienced ‘prejudice or differential treatment’ because of her ‘gender’. AGENCIES

‘Operation Safed Sagar is a zeitgeist project’

Siddharth believes the response to the ‘Netflix’ series has changed the nature of conversations coming his way

The success of ‘Operation Safed Sagar’ is an example of a zeitgeist project, believes Siddharth, who said that the response to the ‘Netflix’ series has changed not only the scale but also the nature of conversations coming his way.

“I’m just very happy that the flight landed and it landed safely. That’s what ‘Operation Safed Sagar’ is to me today,” Siddharth told PTI in an interview.

The actor has been receiving praise for his portrayal of Squadron Leader Ajay Ahuja in the six-episode military drama, which tells the story of the Indian Air Force’s role in the 1999 Kargil War.

Siddharth said the day he signed the project, he knew it would travel and travel deep. “‘Operation Safed Sagar’ is a zeitgeist project. I can tell you the difference between projects that are zeitgeist like this. It’s just that your phone rings very differently. Your messages are received very differently. The width and distance from where those messages come from and the times of day they come from all hits very differently,” he said.

‘Operation Safed Sagar’ follows Indian Air Force’s Golden Arrows Squadron and their high-altitude air campaign during Kargil war, including the extraordinary challenge of conducting air operations at mountainous elevations while being prohibited from crossing the Line of Control. The story focuses on a group of seasoned and young fighter pilots who undertake high-risk combat missions while navigating the emotional and personal costs of war.

Ahuja was killed after his MiG-21 gets hit while on a mission to locate a downed pilot during the Kargil conflict. He was posthumously awarded the Vir Chakra for his courage and sacrifice.

“What we’re getting from day one... the metrics and the optics that are being talked about are authenticity, intention, how it’s different from everything else that’s been related to warfare in the past in fictionalised television or cinema and how it does tribute in the perfect way to Squadron Leader Ajay Ahuja,” Siddharth said.

The actor, known for his performances in ‘Bommarillu’, ‘Chiththa’ and ‘Rang De Basanti’, said the show has also been appreciated for depicting the conflict without resorting to caricature or jingoism. “People have praised how it gets the enemy right without making them caricatures or without empty hate; how it does patriotism without jingoism and how it does technical wizardry without apology that ‘No, we only had this much money to spend on the VFX,’” he said.

Siddharth said one of the most overwhelming aspects of the response has been hearing from senior members of the armed forces. “I’ve been receiving messages from three-star generals and air marshals and that’s very new for me. So that is just because of the pedigree, reputation and sacrifice of Squadron Leader Ajay Ahuja,” he said.

One of the show’s most personal and poignant sequences features Siddharth’s Ajay Ahuja sharing a candid moment with the younger pilots, just hours before the ill-fated flight of his life. The scene captures the veteran pilot’s attempt to ease the nerves of the anxious young



HE HAS BEEN RECEIVING PRAISE FOR HIS PORTRAYAL OF SQUADRON LEADER AJAY AHUJA IN THE SIX-EPIISODE MILITARY DRAMA



men by telling them, ‘Mera bhi pehla war hai yaar (It is my first war as well)’. He then plays the game of Two Truths and a Lie with the pilots, ultimately revealing that joining the air force was not his first option.

For Siddharth, the scene captures something essential about the Indian Air Force and the camaraderie between its personnel. “I found it fascinating that they paused to go into the human being as opposed to shout out his reasons for being nervous, anxious or angry with what’s going to happen next. I love that scene also because of that line, ‘Mera bhi pehla war hai,’” he said.

“If this was not about the Indian Air Force, then I don’t think that scene would have been the same. The volume at which they’re speaking, the kind of camaraderie with which the room is filled. And the lack of age-based or seniority-based status quo that would usually fill a war room the night before the war,” he added.

Siddharth said he has seen senior and junior officers of the Indian Air Force interact so naturally that an outsider could easily be left wondering who outranks whom. “It equalises so quickly. It’s like a teacher telling their student, ‘I haven’t written my exam yet’. Because the teacher usually is expected to know everything. He has done everything. I find that to be one of the gentlest qualities of the show,” he added.

Asked if he found what Squadron Leader Ajay Ahuja’s first option was before he joined the IAF, the actor said he got to know from the officer’s wife Alka that he was an engineering nerd who enjoyed gadgets, photography and acquiring technical knowledge. “I’d like to believe that if Ahuja sir was not a soldier, he might have been an artist like me. He might have been doing something to do with imaging and photography,” he said. PTI

When the horse took him away!

Bhuvan Bam shared his wild horse riding experience for ‘The Revolutionaries’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

For Bhuvan Bam, stepping into the shoes of revolutionary Rash Behari Bose in Prime Video’s upcoming period drama, ‘The Revolutionaries’, came with its fair share of challenges, but none quite as unexpected as horse riding. While embodying the fearless revolutionary came naturally, horse riding was an entirely different story. After a rather unfortunate first lesson involving a runaway horse at Juhu Beach, Bhuvan spent the shoot trying to avoid getting back in the saddle, until he found an unexpected solution for the show’s action sequence.

Recounting the hilarious experience, Bhuvan shared, “So, they told me to learn horse riding. It was a horse* that’s used for wedding functions and took me to Juhu Beach for training. So basically, what happened was that the caretaker was on a phone call and the horse simply ran off with me. That was my first day of horse-riding lessons. If I had fallen from there, I’d probably still be bedridden today. I was literally hanging from the horse and I was shivering for the next three days. The incident reached Nikkhil Advani sir and he took stock of



the situation and I opened up to him and told him that ‘Sir, the horse took me away without my permission! Its leg was stuck in some plastic and it just kept running with me!’”

“The horse-riding scene hadn’t come up yet and every day, I’d wake up thinking, ‘Today I’ll tell sir. Today I’ll finally gather the courage and tell him that I can’t do horse riding’. Then there was a day when one scene went really well and sir was

extremely happy. I thought, ‘Today he is in a good mood’, so I went to him and said, ‘Sir, can I tell you something? Please don’t make me ride the horse. Every day I’m haunted by the thought that the horse might take me away again’, he shared.

So, when it came to filming the action sequence featuring Bose and

General Dyer (played by Jason Shah), Bhuvan had a rather different idea for how the scene could play out. “Let’s switch it,” said Bhuvan. “By then, I had spoken to Dyer enough to know that he was a kick-ass horse rider. They had given him the bike and given me the horse. So, I said, ‘Sir, let’s switch’. He was such a good horse rider that, at times, the horse was actually overtaking the bike. And then we did it and it was so swift!”

Inspired by true events and set against the backdrop of India’s freedom struggle, the period drama is directed and created for a series by acclaimed filmmaker Nikkhil Advani. Based on Sanjeev Sanyal’s bestseller ‘Revolutionaries: The Other Story Of How India Won Its Freedom’, ‘The Revolutionaries’ features an ensemble cast, with Bhuvan Bam, Rohit Saraf, Pratibha Ranta and Gurfateh Pirzada in lead roles, along with Jason Shah, Paoli Dam and Tota Roy Chowdhury in key roles. The series premieres on September 11.

*No animals were harmed during the filming of the series

‘THE REVOLUTIONARIES’ STARS BHUVAN BAM, ROHIT SARAF & OTHERS IN LEAD ROLES